

Town of Lenox

Massachusetts



2025

Annual Report



Annual Report
of the
Town Officers
of the
Town of Lenox
Massachusetts



For the Year Ending
31 December 2025

Town in Transition

Three key members of Town Staff retired in 2025. Fire Department Chief Christopher O'Brien, Town Clerk, Kerry Sullivan, and Police Department Chief Stephen O'Brien.



Chief C. O'Brien applauds incoming Fire Chief, Robert Casucci, at the Change of Command ceremony in front of Central Station in June.



Chief S. O'Brien welcomes incoming Police Chief, Mark Smith, at the Change of Command ceremony in the Community Room at the new Public Safety Complex in November.



Kerry Sullivan performs her final act as Town Clerk by swearing Paul Mattingly as her replacement in the Town Offices at Town Hall in December.

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General information

POPULATION:

1767: Fifteen families (required for incorporation)
2023: 4976
2024: 4733
2025: 4964

SCHOOL POPULATION:

2023: 783
2024: 765
2025: 762

REGISTERED VOTERS:

2023: 3897
2024: 3822
2025: 3875

TAX RATE:

2023-24: \$9.07 Residential; \$12.85 Comm./Ind./Pers. Prop.
2024-25: \$9.05 Residential; \$13.18 Comm./Ind./Pers. Prop.
2025-26: \$9.85 Residential; \$14.37 Comm./Ind./Pers. Prop.

LOCATION:

Center of Town about 1200 feet elevation
Northern Boundary: Pittsfield
Southern Boundary: Lee & Stockbridge
Western Boundary: Richmond
Eastern Boundary: Washington & Lee
Highway Mileage: State 10.80 Miles and Town 50.34 Miles
 and 2.8 Miles of unaccepted roads

Business Hours of Town Offices

8:30am to 4:00pm

COUNCIL ON AGING OFFICE

Monday-Friday 9:00am to 2:00pm

Board Meetings of Town Officials

BOARD OF SELECTMEN

Scheduled Wednesdays @ 6:00pm

SCHOOL COMMITTEE

Scheduled Mondays @ 6:30pm in the Town Hall

BOARD OF ASSESSORS

As needed basis

BOARD OF HEALTH

Quarterly, and as needed basis

HOUSING AUTHORITY

First Tuesday of each month @ 4:30pm at the Curtis Complex

PLANNING BOARD

Second & Fourth Tuesday of each month @ 6:00pm

COMMUNITY CENTER BOARD

Third Wednesday of each month @ 7:00pm at the Community Center

CONSERVATION COMMISSION

First & Third Thursday of each month @ 7:30pm

FINANCE COMMITTEE

As needed Wednesdays @ 7:00pm

HISTORIC DISTRICT COMMISSION

First & Third Tuesday of each month @ 5:30pm

HISTORICAL COMMISSION

Second Thursday of each month @ 4:00pm at The Academy

VETERANS

Office Hours every Tuesday from 4:00-6:00pm at the Town Hall

ZONING BOARD OF APPEALS

First & Third Wednesday of each month @ 7:00pm

Town Offices Telephone Directory

EMERGENCY POLICE

Local Department	637 2346
State Police	243 0600

FIRE DEPARTMENT

To report a fire or an emergency or to request ambulance assistance	911
EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT	637 2346

TOWN HALL	637-5500
DEPARTMENT	TELEPHONE
Accountant	X-8
Animal Control Officer	243-5540
Assessors	X-2
Birth,Death,Marriage Certificates	X-4
Building/Sign Inspector	243-5518
Community Center Game Room	637 4487
Community Center Director	637-5530
Council on Aging	637-5535
Dept. of Public Works	637 5525
Dog Licenses	X-4
Emergency Management Director	637 2347
Fire Dept. Lenox Dale Station	637 5542
Fire Dept. New Lenox Station	442 2567
Health Inspector	243 5540
Highway/Roads	637 5520
Housing Authority	637 5585
Land Use	X-6
Lenox Town Beach	637 2352
Library	637 0197
License Board Selectmen	X-7
Parks & Recreation Community Center	637-5530
Planner	X-6
Planning Board	X-6
Plumbing Inspector	637-0645
School Department	637 5550
Lenox Memorial Middle High	637 5560
Morris Elementary	637 5570
School Superintendent	637 5550
Selectmen	X-7
Sewer	637-5520
Taxes, Water, Sewer Bills	X-5
Town Manager	X-7
Treasurer/Collector	X-1208
Trees	637 5525
Veterans' Agent	X-1204
Vital Statistics	X-4
Voting Regulations	X-4
Water	637 5525
Wire Inspector	499-2431
Zoning Board of Appeals	X-6

Town Officials

MODERATOR

John McNinch

BOARD OF SELECTMEN

Max Scherff, Chair

Edward Lane

Neal Maxymillian

Marybeth Mitts

David Roche

TOWN MANAGER

Jay Green

EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT

Deanna Garner

SCHOOL COMMITTEE

Oren Cass, Chair

Michael DuPont, Vice-Chair

Kim Graham, Secretary

Richard Burke

Veronica Fenton

Meghan Kirby

Jayson Messenger

Robert Munch

David Rimmner

Kim Winger

Greta Mathews, Student Representative

SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS

William Collins

DIRECTOR OF BUSINESS SERVICES

Melissa Falkowski

BOARD OF ASSESSORS

Thomas Romeo

Jaimy Messana

Wayne Lemanski

ADMINISTRATIVE ASSESSOR

Heather Durant

BOARD OF HEALTH

John Kearns,
Dr. Noel Blagg
Dianne Romeo

HEALTH INSPECTOR

James Wilusz

HOUSING AUTHORITY

Carol Ramsey
Deb Prew
Kim Graham
Linda Carroll

HOUSING AUTHORITY EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Shannon Cella

PLANNING BOARD

Tom Delasco
Pam Kueber
Kathleen McNulty-Vaughan
Dan Bross
Mark Smith

Appointed Officials

BOARDS & COMMITTEES

ACADEMY BUILDING TRUSTEE

Victoria Salvatore
Tim Face
Scott Pignatelli

ADMINISTRATIVE ALARM BOARD

Chris O'Brien
Kevin Dinan
Steve O'Brien

AFFORDABLE HOUSING TRUSTEES

Kate McNulty-Vaughan
Clerk, Don Weber
Chris Fenton
Jackie McNinch
Marybeth Mitts
Smitty Pignatelli
Olga Weiss

COMMUNITY CENTER BOARD

Sheri Gaherty
Francie Sheehan-Sorrentino
Rose Fitzgerald-Casey
Peg Amendola
Kristie Prew
Jared Weber
Sara Jarvie

COMMUNITY CENTER DIRECTOR

Shannon O'Brien

COA COORDINATOR

Liz Maturevich

PROGRAM MANAGER

Casi Krissant

CUSTODIAN

Bruce Huber

COA VAN DRIVER

Kevin Dondi

COMMUNITY PRESERVATION COMMITTEE

Tom Delasco (Planning Board)
Mark Smith (Conservation Commission)
Kim Graham (Housing Authority)
Neal Maxymillian (Board of Selectmen)
Olga Weiss (Historical Commission)
Frederick Keator (at-large)
Chuck Koscher (at-large)
Vacancy (at-large)
Jared Weber (Community Center)

CONSERVATION COMMISSION

Neal Carpenter
David Lane
Vince Ammendola
Rosemary Fitzgerald Casey
Richard Ferren
Mark Smith

FINANCE COMMITTEE

Alison Brigham
Kristine Cass
Blaise Gregory
Kevin Kump
Josh Levin
Hank Maimin
Mindi Morin
Rebecca Robak

BOARD OF HEALTH OFFICIALS

James Wilusz, Health Inspector
Kerry Sullivan, Recorder
James Leahey, Inspector of Animals, Stables

HISTORIC DISTRICT COMMISSION

Jason Berger
Aurelien Telle
Pat Jaouen
Ken Fowler
Peggy Ammendola
David Joseph

HISTORICAL COMMISSION

Olga Weiss, Chair
Jan Chague
Davis Dyer
Rick Gregg
Tom Romeo
Jan Chague, alternate
Kimberly Duval, alternate

JOHN DRUMMOND KENNEDY PARK RESTORATION COMMITTEE

Sue Lyman
Ruth H. Wheeler, Chair
Stephen Alsdorf
Luke Martin
Tom Roche
Ray Kirby
Terry P. Weaver
Mark Pignatelli

LENOX CULTURAL COUNCIL

Robin Kimbrough-Melton
Doug Pollock, Treasurer
Winnie Vahle
Harriet Wetstone
Kimberly Duval
Gabriela Sheehan

Town Officials

APPOINTED BY SELECT BOARD

William Gop - Fence Viewer, Field Driver,
Surveyor of Lumber, Measurer, Wood & Bark, Tree Warden
Comm. of MA - Sealer Weights & Measures

PERMANENT BUILDING COMMITTEE

Edward Lane
Andrew Lane
Jeff Vincent
Neal Maxymillian
Tom Delasco

REGISTRAR OF VOTERS

Kerry Sullivan
Anne M. Moore
Kay Oft
Paul Mattingly

SCHOLARSHIP COMMITTEE

Dr. William E. Collins, Ex-Officio
Paula Downer
Amy Lafave
Bill Parsley

Tara Romeo
James Sorrentino

ZONING BOARD OF APPEALS

Robert Fuster, Jr., Chair
Shawn Leary Considine, Clerk
John Simons (Associate)
Albert Harper
Jedd Hall (Associate)
Donna Pignatelli (Associate)
Arthur Oliver
Christine Conklin (Associate)
Daniel Schenker

POLICE DEPARTMENT

Mark L. Smith, Chief of Police
Michael T. Smith, Sergeant & SRT
William C. Colvin, Patrolman & School Resource Officer
Eric R. Kirby, Patrolman
Tyler W. Bosworth, Patrolman & Detective
B. Jake Stringer, Patrolman & Sex Offender Registry
Colin J. Benner, Patrolman
Kevin M. Shook, Patrolman & SRT
James C. Forgett, Patrolman
Marc E. Tousey, Patrolman
Dominic R. Bartini, Patrolman
Travis M. Derby, Patrolman
Dylan P. Tyer, Patrolman
Cameron Sibley, Reserve Patrol Officer

POLICE SECRETARY

Marjorie Pero

EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT DIRECTOR, FIRE WARDEN, FOREST
WARDEN AND INSPECTOR OF FIRE DEPARTMENT

Chris O'Brien (Retired June 2025)
Robert Casucci

CAREER FIREFIGHTER/EMT'S

Robert Casucci, Chief
Jason Saunders, Deputy Chief
Dan Piretti, Captain
Larry Morse, FF/Paramedic

Matthew Williams, FF/Paramedic
Joshua Romeo, FF/Paramedic
Cameron Sibley, FF/Paramedic
Paige DiGrigoli, FF/Paramedic
Christopher Prew, FF/EMT
Matt Tyer, FF/Paramedic

RELIEF FIREFIGHTER/EMT'S

Mike Zinchuk, Captain
Aurelien Telle, FF/EMT
Richard Shove, FF/EMT
Mychal Shove, FF/EMT
Jacob Soldato, FF/EMT
Kyle Marcantel, FF/EMT
Kenneth Rosen, FF/EMT

CALL/VOLUNTEER FIREFIGHTERS

Mitchell Arseneau, Firefighter
Matthew Boulais, Firefighter
Matthew Bradbury, Firefighter
Andrew Casucci, JR Firefighter
Emma Casucci, Firefighter
Bill Colvin, Deputy Chief
Steve Coon, Firefighter
Ethan Fairfield, Firefighter
Scott Forbes, Lieutenant
Bill Gop, Firefighter
Jackson Kamienski, JR Firefighter
Luke Kamienski, Firefighter
Owen Kamienski, JR Firefighter
Colman Keator, JR Firefighter
Jeffery Kane, Assistant Chief
Caleb Ketchen, JR Firefighter
John Kluka, Firefighter
Matt Lane, Firefighter
Jeff Lynch, Firefighter
Cam Marcantel, Firefighter
Lucas Maturevich, Firefighter
Justin Mercer, Firefighter
Jordan Meyer, Firefighter
Jason Miller, Firefighter
Michael Ozner, Firefighter
Chelcy Patel, JR Firefighter

Jim Prew, Firefighter
Brian-Logan Reid, Firefighter
Emmitt Shove, Firefighter
Gordon Shove, Firefighter
Katie Shove, JR Firefighter
Jason Sibley, JR Firefighter
Cayden Smachetti, JR Firefighter
TJ Smachetti, Firefighter
Thomas Stebens, Firefighter

BUILDING COMMISSIONER/ZONING OFFICER

Matthew Kollmer

LOCAL BUILDING INSPECTOR

Rian Dowd
Adam Vanderneck
Don Fitzgerald

BUILDING INSPECTOR CLERK

Carolyn Hogencamp

WIRE INSPECTOR

Mike Burton

PLUMBING/GAS INSPECTOR

Mark Smith

VETERANS' AGENT

Lloyd D. Mann

ANIMAL CONTROL OFFICER

Kacey Hatch

CONSTABLE

Stephen O'Brien
Timothy S. Face (Deputy/Collector)

BERKSHIRE REGIONAL TRANSIT AUTHORITY REPRESENTATIVE

Mindi Morin

BERKSHIRE REGIONAL PLANNING COMMISSION DELEGATE

Mark Smith
Daniel Bross, Alternate

GOVERNOR OF MASSACHUSETTS

Maura Healey

REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS

Edward Markey
Elizabeth Warren

UNITED STATES REPRESENTATIVE

Richard Neal

REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT STATE SENATOR

Paul Mark

STATE REPRESENTATIVE

Leigh Davis

TOWN COUNSEL

KP Law, P.C.

TOWN PLANNER

Eammon Coughlin

LAND USE ASSISTANT

Neena Martino

TOWN TREASURER/COLLECTOR

Katherin Phillips

ASSISTANT TREASURER/COLLECTOR

Jose Aguilar

TOWN CLERK

Kerry Sullivan

ASSITANT TOWN CLERK

Paul Mattingly
(Town Clerk as of Dec. 19, 2025)

TOWN ACCOUNTANT

Anna Osborn

HUMAN RESOURCES/RISK MANAGEMENT

Lyndsay Patenaude

SUPERINTENDENT OF PUBLIC WORKS

William Gop

ASSISTANT SUPERINTENDENT OF PUBLIC WORKS

Jeffrey Carpenter

DPW OFFICE MANAGER

Neena Martino

DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS EMPLOYEES

Daniel T. Kirby, Cemetery Foreman

Paul Vallee, Mechanic

Travis DelRatez, Water Department Foreman

Tyler Collins, Laborer/ Truck Driver

Steve Flanders, Laborer

Patrick Reagan, Water Treatment Plant Operator

TJ Smachetti, Laborer / Truck Driver

Jeffrey L. White, Wastewater Plant Foreman

Kevin Turner, Water Laborer

Scott Forbes, Wastewater Plant Operator

Brendan Armstrong, Laborer / Truck Driver

John Gaherty, Facilities

LIBRARY

Katherine O'Neil, Library Director

Amy Lafave, Local History Librarian

Christy Cordova, Information Librarian

Vanessa Dion, Collections Librarian

Vanessa Justice, Youth Librarian

Sara Jarvie, Youth Assistant

Megan Mackey, Circulation Coordinator

Anjani Nelson, Library Associate

Stephanie Storie, Library Associate

Katy Holt, Library Associate

Gene Lagonia, Facilities Manager

LIBRARY BOARD OF TRUSTEES

Brenda Durrin, Secretary

Robert Horvath, Chair

Marybeth Mitts, Select Board Liaison

Max Scherff, Select Board Liaison

Shawnee Tannenbaum

Sally Vincent

Town of Lenox Committee Application

Name: Last First Middle

Address: Number/Street P.O. Box City State Zip

Telephone: Email:

What aroused your interest in serving the town? Newspaper Ad Friend Legal Notice Other

Have you previously served on a Town Committee? If so, when?

Which Committee(s)?

Work Experience:

Educational Background:

What are your community interests?

Are you available on a year-round basis? I believe I could contribute hours a month. I would like to serve Lenox and might be interested in serving on the following Committees. If more than one, please indicate preference, 1, 2, 3, etc.

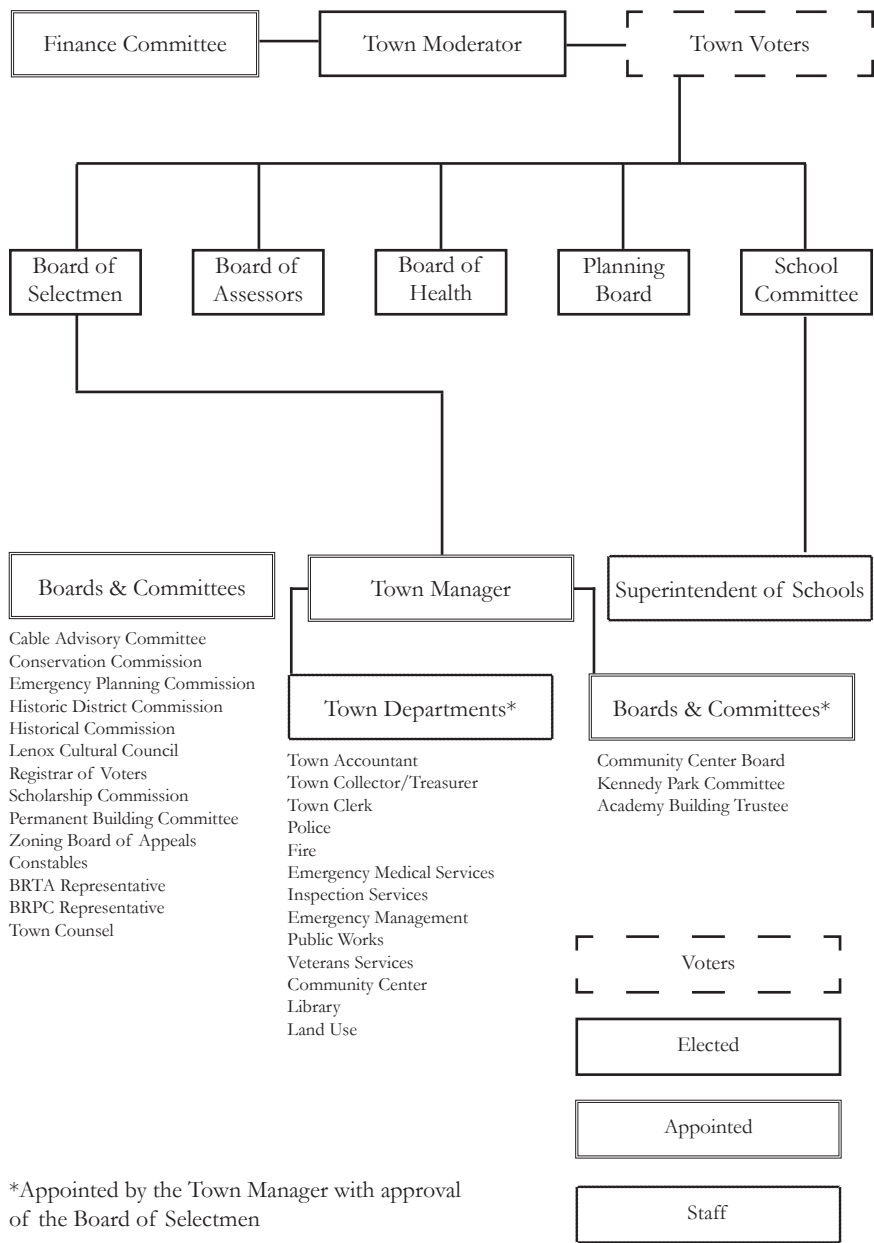
- Academy Building Committee
- Affordable Housing
- Ambulance Squad
- Cable Advisory Committee
- Community Center Board
- Community Preservation Committee
- Conservation Commission
- Environmental Committee
- Finance Committee
- Historical Commission
- Historic District Commission
- Kennedy Park Committee
- Lenox Cultural Council
- Permanent Building Committee
- Police Department Special Traffic Officer
- Registrar of Voters
- Scholarship Committee
- Zoning Board of Appeals

RETURN TO: Board of Selectmen, Town Hall - 6 Walker Street, Lenox, MA 01240 THIS APPLICATION WILL BE PLACED ON FILE FOR REFERENCE WHEN A VACANCY OCCURS.

If you wish to be reappointed to a position that you currently hold, please complete this section of the form..

Name: Position currently held: Term to be reappointed until:

Governmental Structure



Report of the Board of Selectmen

To the Honorable Citizens of Lenox:

The five person Selectboard serves as the goal setting, long range planning and policy making body of the town, recommending major courses of action to the town meeting, and adopting policy directives and guidelines which are implemented by the town manager and town staff along with the boards, committees, and commissions of the town. Through our Town Manager, the Selectboard exercises general supervision over all matters affecting the interests and welfare of our community.

The Selectboard also acts as the Town's Local Licensing Authority, hearing petitions for new licenses, amendments to existing licenses and one-day licenses. With a vibrant hospitality sector and community events, this makes up a large part of the Selectboard's routine business. In addition, the Selectboard is also responsible for determining equitable use policies for town buildings and public spaces for various cultural and community events.

The challenging, day-to-day work of keeping our community one of the most desirable places to live and visit in the Commonwealth rests with our Town Manager and staff. 2025 saw considerable turnover in some very critical roles, including Town Manager, Town Clerk, Fire Chief and Police Chief. In addition, positions in various departments and volunteers on a variety of boards and committees also experienced turnover.

We are incredibly pleased to report that at the end of calendar year 2025, our town staffing is stable, and those roles have been filled with very capable, dedicated and experienced individuals who will continue to move Lenox forward. We are fortunate in Lenox to be able to recruit and retain talented staff who work long hours to deliver quality services to our residents. We would like to thank all of our Town staff for their hard work and commitment to Lenox.

In addition to our full-time staff, we have several boards and committees which perform very critical functions within our Town government. Without exception, these dedicated volunteers serve without any compensation and devote many hours to our community's betterment. We thank them for their service and we encourage you to consider serving on a board or committee in the future.

Respectfully submitted,
Max Scherff, Chair
Neal Maxymillain, Clerk
Ed Lane
Marybeth Mitts
Dave Roche

Report of the Town Manager

To the Honorable Members of the Selectboard and the citizens of Lenox:

A Solid Foundation

In preparing for this year's annual town report, I reviewed several past submissions to get a sense as to what information was included. It was not a surprise to see that as far back as 2010, several of the same challenges that face Lenox today were present then: the cost of providing staff and retiree health insurance, the growing list of expensive capital projects and the pressure of providing quality municipal services while moderating tax impacts. This is the same fiscal environment that Lenox and other communities across the Commonwealth operate in year over year and will likely do so into the future.

Over the past several years, Lenox has taken successful steps to address these challenges: the use of Stabilization Funds, creating an OPEB (Other Post Employment Benefits) Trust Fund, authorizing the local option meals tax, developing shared service models, employing conservative budget forecasting, following sound financial management policies and utilizing an annual capital improvement plan, adapting to changing economic conditions.

These practices have resulted in a fiscally stable, well positioned Town to manage these enduring challenges in a responsible and efficient manner. In the most recent Standard & Poors "AAA" credit rating report that provides an independent assessment on the quality of a community, it was noted that Lenox has "[a] strong operating track record that we believe is sustainable, given budgeting strategies and performance of local revenue, with reserves that we expect to increase in fiscal 2026."

Building off this foundation, accomplishments in 2025 include securing open space at Kennedy Park, the commissioning of our new Public Safety Complex, launching the Wastewater Treatment Plant upgrade project, finishing downtown improvements and continued investment in our public infrastructure such as roads and water main replacements. Less visible, but no less critical were improvements made to our internal processes such as time & attendance, managed technology services, and other business

systems with the goal of delivering services efficiently and more effectively – we have more work to do in 2026.

It may feel as though Lenox is changing, especially with the most significant personnel changes in recent Town history. A new Town Manager, a new Town Planner, a recently new Town Accountant and the retirements of our Fire Chief, Police Chief and Town Clerk – all dedicated public servants – has resulted in new faces, names and ways of doing things. Lenox is incredibly fortunate to have talented people fill these roles with the energy, ideas and dedication to keep Lenox the community we all appreciate. Lenox has a strong identity, a positive culture of collaboration, respect for our neighbors, and a deep commitment to good government. It is an honor to serve as Town Manager and continue to move this community forward.

Respectfully Submitted,

Jay R. Green
Town Manager

Report of the Town Collector

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

I respectfully submit a detailed description of all revenues as of June 30, 2025

Real Estate Tax	\$18,321,616.09
CPA	481,257.22
Tax Title	16,190.50
Personal Property Tax	891,333.33
Motor Vehicle Excise Tax	934,567.03
Real Estate, CPA Interest & Demand Fees	114,203.21
Tax Title Interest	8,079.53
Personal Property Interest & Demand Fees	1,636.56
Motor Vehicle Excise Interest & Demand Fees	13,399.26
W/S Rates & Interest	3,516,255.72
W/S Demand Fees	30,872.29
W/S Tie-in Fees	39,600.00
DPW Misc. Fees	34,189.25
Cemetery Fees	5,750.00
Perpetual Care Fees	16,800.00
Cemetery Lot Fees	5,600.00
Parking Tickets	2,600.00
Municipal Lien Certificates	8,250.00
Trailer Court Fees	8,832.00
Scholarship Fund	29,118.73
Registry of Motor Vehicles Surcharges	4,180.00
Deputy Collector Fees	9,325.00
	\$24,493,655.72

The Town has currently 11 properties in Tax Title. We have been working diligently with many of them to prevent foreclosure.

Respectfully submitted,
Katherin Y. Phillips, Treasurer-Collector
Jose Aguilar, Asst. Treasurer-Collector

Report of the Town Clerk

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

For the Year Ending December 31, 2025

DOG LICENSES

Dog Licenses Issued	685
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VITAL STATISTICS

Births	16
Deaths	155
Marriages	49

RAFFLE PERMITS

Raffle Permits Issued	4
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BUSINESS CERTIFICATES

Business Certificates Issued	37
Business Certificates Renewed	71

Respectfully submitted,
Paul Mattingly, Town Clerk

Report of the Elections and Registrations

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

For the year ending December 31, 2025

Registered Voters	3875
Unenrolled	1806
Democrat	1207
Republican	192
Libertarian	10
Green-Rainbow	2
American Independent	2
Inter. 3rd Party	2
Socialist	2
Pirate Party	1

2025 Elections	Total Votes Cast
Local May 5, 2025	746

2025 Town Meetings	Attendance
Annual May 1, 2025	265
Special November 6, 2025	215

Respectfully submitted,
Paul Mattingly, Town Clerk
Kay V. Oft, Registrar
Anne M, Moore, Registrar

Report of the Town Treasurer

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

I respectfully submit a detailed description of all revenues as of June 30, 2025:

Cash on hand June 30, 2025	\$67,354,642.43
Cash Receipts July 1, 2024, to June 30, 2025	\$98,703,382.56
Cash Payments July 1, 2024, to June 30, 2025	\$(84,391,766.33)
Balance	\$81,666,258.66
Funds in Various Banks:	
Checking Accounts	\$1,294,220.20
Liquid Investments	\$31,993,906.55
Term Investments	\$16,940,388.84
Trust Funds	\$31,437,743.07
All Cash Investments as of June 30, 2025	\$81,666,258.66

The Treasurer’s Department has the following criteria: to receive receipts and have care and custody of all monies, property, and securities of the Town of Lenox; to invest said funds in the best possible way following the guidelines of Safety, Liquidity, and Yield. To negotiate all borrowings, collect financial data and prepare documents relevant to accurate and current financial planning.

Respectfully submitted,
Katherin Y. Phillips, Treasurer-Collector
Jose Aguilar, Asst. Treasurer-Collector

Report of the Board of Assessors

To the Honorable Office of the Select Board and Citizens of Lenox,

The primary function of the Assessing Office is to provide the assessment of full and fair market values, i.e. “the amount a willing buyer would pay and willing seller on the open market” in accordance with Massachusetts General Laws and regulations, of all real and personal property in Lenox is to equitably allocate Lenox’s annual tax levy amongst Lenox taxpayers. We also evaluate all applications for abatement of such property tax, motor vehicle excise tax and make the determination of taxpayer eligibility for statutory exemptions.

The Town of Lenox offers personal tax exemptions for the following categories, Blind, Senior, Disabled Veteran, Hardship, Senior Work-off and Low-Income CPA exemption. Contact the Assessors Clerk for this annual application or additional information regarding qualification requirements.

The Town of Lenox is a quarterly billing community whose Fiscal Year (FY) starts on July 1 and ends on June 30th. The tax bills should arrive on the first day of July, October, January, April and are due within 30 days.

The Massachusetts Department of Revenue (DOR) mandates that every city/town fully update its property assessments each fiscal year to reflect the fair market value. The updated property assessments are submitted to the DOR each fiscal year for their review and approval before Lenox’s tax rate can be set by the town’s Select Board Members.

Lenox total assessed valuation in FY2026 was \$2,026,230,630, an increase of 10.0% over the assessed total valuation for FY2025. We added \$504,638 of new tax revenue. The increases in assessments and new growth, limited the tax increase in light of the town’s budget increase. This resulted to a residential tax increase from \$9.05 to \$9.85 and a commercial/industrial/personal property tax rate increase from \$13.18 to \$14.37.

The Lenox Board of Assessors chair and members remained the same,

Thomas Romeo, Chairman, Jaimy Messana, Clerk, Wayne Lemanski, Member, Heather Durant, Assessors Clerk.

Assessed Values and Tax Rates for Fiscal Year 2026 are as follows:

FY2026	Lenox Assessed Values	Tax Rate
Residential	\$1,627,021,539	\$ 9.85
Commercial	\$ 308,094,051	\$14.37
Industrial	\$ 11,309,700	\$14.37
Personal Property	\$ 79,805,340	\$14.37
Lenox Total Value	\$2,026,230,630	

Lenox 2024 Budget	\$ 18,477,776
Amount to be raised thru taxation	\$ 21,762,797
Exempt Properties	\$208,114,200

Lenox Real Estate Accounts	2973
Personal property Accounts	648

Respectfully Submitted,

Board of Assessors
Thomas Romeo, Chairman
Wayne W. Lemanski, Member
Jaimy Messana, Member
Heather Durant, Assessors' Clerk

Report of the Town Accountant

Balance Sheet Governmental Funds
June 30, 2025

	<u>General Fund</u>
Assets:	
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$11,344,981
Investments	32,711,809
Receivables, net of allowance for uncollectibles:	
Property Taxes	263,868
Tax Liens	168,588
Excise Taxes	100,344
Departmental	206,567
Due from Other Governments	4,376
Total Assets	<u>\$44,800,533</u>
Liabilities:	
Warrants Payable	\$367,126
Accrued Payroll	1,523,344
Employee Withholdings	261,253
Other	1,362
Bond Anticipation Notes Payable	-
Total Liabilities	<u>2,153,085</u>
Deferred Inflows of Resources - Unavailable Revenue	<u>661,690</u>
Fund Balance:	
Nonspendable	-
Restricted	-
Committed	2,737,026
Assigned	4,357,146
Unassigned	34,891,586
Total Fund Balance	<u>41,985,758</u>
Total Liabilities, Deferred Inflows of Resources and Fund Balances	<u>\$44,800,533</u>

New Public Safety Building Construction Fund	Roads and Sidewalks Constuction Fund	Nonmajor Governmental Funds	Total Governmental Funds
\$4,910,098	\$373,504	\$9,946,965	\$26,575,548
-	-	325,974	33,037,783
-	-	6,380	270,248
-	-	2,449	171,037
-	-	-	100,344
-	-	-	206,567
-	-	700,900	705,276
\$4,910,098	\$373,504	\$10,982,668	\$61,066,803
\$ -	\$ -	\$66,045	\$433,171
-	-	15,744	1,539,118
-	-	-	261,253
-	-	-	1,362
21,900,000	3,000,000	-	24,900,000
21,900,000	3,000,000	81,819	27,134,904
-	-	567,834	1,229,524
-	-	289,998	289,998
-	-	10,043,017	10,043,017
-	-	-	2,737,026
-	-	-	4,357,146
(16,989,902)	(2,626,496)	-	15,275,188
(16,989,902)	(2,626,496)	10,333,015	32,702,375
\$4,910,098	\$373,504	\$10,982,668	\$61,066,803

**Statement of Expenditures and
Revenues for the Year Ended
June 30, 2025**

	BUDGETED	
	Amounts Carried Forward from Prior Year	Original Budget
Revenues:		
Property Taxes	\$	\$18,897,820
Intergovernmental	-	2,137,155
Excise and Other Taxes	-	766,250
Hotel Room Occupancy and Meal Taxes	-	2,500,000
Licenses, Permits, Fees	-	510,290
Charges for Services - Ambulance	-	643,155
Interest and Penalties on Taxes	-	80,000
Investment Income	-	300,000
Total Revenues	-	25,834,670
Expenditures:		
Current:		
General Government	346,594	2,156,747
Public Safety	465,059	3,112,706
Public Works	1,392,277	1,421,495
Education	518,053	17,657,772
Health and Human Services	-	306,659
Culture and Recreation	491,364	1,297,112
Unallocated Employee Benefits and Insurance	-	1,665,377
Intergovernmental Assessments	-	325,909
Debt Service:		
Principal	-	155,000
Interest	-	91,125
Total Expenditures	3,213,347	28,189,902
Excess of Revenues Over (Under) Expenditures	(3,213,347)	(2,355,232)
Other Financing Sources (Uses):		
Operating Transfers In	-	-
Operating Transfers Out	-	(225,000)
Total Other Financing Sources (Uses)	-	(225,000)
Net Change in Budgetary Fund Balance	(3,213,347)	(2,580,232)
Other Budgetary Items:		
Free Cash and Other Reserves	-	2,580,232
Prior Year Encumbrances	3,213,347	-
Total Other Budgetary Items	3,213,347	2,580,232
Net Budget	\$ -	\$ -

AMOUNTS

Final Budget	Actual Budgetary Basis	Amounts Carried Forward to Next Year	Variance with Final Budget Positive (Negative)
\$18,897,820	\$19,162,904	\$ -	\$265,084
2,137,155	2,162,967	-	25,812
766,250	960,715	-	194,465
2,500,000	4,557,668	-	2,057,668
510,290	969,549	-	459,259
643,155	818,371	-	175,216
80,000	125,029	-	45,029
300,000	1,483,012	-	1,183,012
25,834,670	30,240,215	-	4,405,545
2,415,178	1,830,684	439,375	145,119
3,519,706	3,078,884	416,369	24,453
3,934,620	2,704,792	1,227,528	2,300
18,175,825	17,254,076	627,058	294,691
364,718	343,168	-	21,550
1,834,159	1,458,654	363,382	12,123
1,687,009	1,687,009	-	-
325,909	275,334	-	50,575
155,000	155,000	-	-
91,125	249,511	-	(158,386)
32,503,249	29,037,112	3,073,712	392,425
(6,668,579)	1,203,103	(3,073,712)	4,797,970
-	-	-	-
(26,399,207)	(26,399,207)	-	-
(26,399,207)	(26,399,207)	-	-
-	-	-	-
(33,067,786)	(\$ 25,196,104)	(\$ 3,073,712)	\$ 4,797,970
29,854,439			
3,213,347			
33,067,786			
\$ -			

Statement of Net Position Proprietary Funds**June 30, 2025****ENTERPRISE FUNDS**

	Sewer Fund	Water Fund	Total
ASSETS			
CURRENT:			
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$10,192,731	\$610,810	\$10,803,541
Investments	756,788	974,721	1,731,509
User Charges, net of allowance for uncollectibles	198,261	100,112	298,373
Total current assets	11,147,780	1,685,643	12,833,423
NONCURRENT:			
Capital Assets, net of accumulated depreciation:			
Nondepreciable	3,727,784	629,492	4,357,276
Depreciable	11,937,450	15,844,288	27,781,738
Total noncurrent assets	15,665,234	16,473,780	32,139,014
Total Assets	26,813,014	18,159,423	44,972,437

DEFERRED OUTFLOWS OF RESOURCES

Deferred Outflows Related to Pensions	21,065	26,810	47,875
Deferred Outflows Related to OPEB	6,011	19,012	25,023
Total Deferred Outflows of Resources	27,076	45,822	72,898

LIABILITIES

CURRENT:			
Warrants and Accounts Payable	129,218	9,516	138,734
Accrued Payroll	5,807	7,182	12,989
Accrued Interest	117,755	7,723	125,478
Bond Anticipation Notes Payable	12,350,000	-	12,350,000
Bonds Payable	625,000	170,000	795,000
Total current liabilities	13,227,780	194,421	13,422,201
NONCURRENT:			
Compensated Absences	9,108	16,032	25,140
Net OPEB Liability	54,235	171,549	225,784
Net Pension Liability	857	1,091	1,948
Bonds Payable	4,871,000	2,244,000	7,115,000
Total noncurrent liabilities	4,935,200	2,432,672	7,367,872
Total Liabilities	18,162,980	2,627,093	20,790,073

DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES

Deferred Inflows Related to Pensions	2,814	3,582	6,396
Deferred Inflows Related to OPEB	10,307	32,601	42,908
Total Deferred Inflows of Resources	13,121	36,183	49,304

NET POSITION

Net Investment in Capital Assets	7,516,336	14,059,780	21,576,116
Restricted for Capital Projects	109,336	145,334	254,670
Unrestricted	1,038,317	1,336,855	2,375,172
Total Net Position	\$8,663,989	\$15,541,969	\$24,205,958

Report of the Finance Committee

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

The Finance Committee meets regularly to review financial issues facing the town. As stated in Mass DOR's Guide to Financial Management for Town Officials, "The finance committee is the official fiscal watchdog for a town. Because it is difficult for all taxpayers to be completely informed about every aspect of a town's finances, finance committees were established so a representative group of taxpayers could conduct a thorough review of municipal finance questions on behalf of all citizens."

The Finance Committee's priorities are:

- Maintain moderate annual increases in the operating budget so that residential property taxes remain affordable for taxpayers
- Inform taxpayers of the impact that the town's budgeting decisions will have on their future property tax bills
- Review and question all department operating budgets to confirm that funds are spent wisely
- Understand capital projects and the impact that capital investment and debt will have on future tax burden
- Ensure appropriate investment to maintain the town's physical infrastructure and level of services
- Strengthen relationships with departments and committees driving the town budget, including the Select Board and School Committee/ Administration

Thank you to the Town Manager, Town Accountants, and department heads for their careful budget preparation and effective cost management. We also thank the Select Board for their continued dedication to the well-being of our town.

Respectfully Submitted,
Alison Brigham
Kristine Cass, Chair
Blaise Gregory
Kevin Kump
Josh Levin
Hank Maimin
Mindi Morin, Secretary
Rebecca Robak

Report of the Housing Authority

To the Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

The Lenox Housing Authority had fourteen (14) new vacancies: eleven (11) at the Curtis and three (3) at Turnure Terrace. We were able to provide housing for four (4) people who lived or worked in Lenox under the “local preference”. We also housed three (3) veterans. Applications can be found online at publichousingapplication.ocd.state.ma.us. Applicants may call or stop by the office to pick up an application or visit our website at www.lenoxhousingauthority.com. Current net income guidelines apply; Criminal Offense Records and references are investigated.

The State Capital Planning System continues to fund scheduled projects for the authority in order to be proactive with the maintenance of our properties. Some capital projects that have been completed in this past year: repairing and renovating the side porch at 25 West Street which provides a home to 8 physically and mentally challenged adults and is managed by BCARC, modernization work in one of our elderly/handicapped units at Turnure Terrace with a full renovation, upgrading the bathrooms in our two (2) handicapped family units at 13 Church Street to make them ADA compliant along with installing a new front walkway.

At the end of the year, Mike Sullivan, the full-time maintenance mechanic retired from the Lenox Housing Authority. Mike spent the last six 6 years with the Housing Authority and was a huge part of the community. He will be missed and we wish him the best in his retirement! We are happy to have Timothy Wilson, Mike’s part-time helper as the new full-time maintenance mechanic. Tim has been working along with Mike for the past three (3) years and we are excited about the experience and knowledge that he brings to the table.

A special thank you to our Lenox Firefighters, Lenox Police Officers, and Lenox Emergency Response Personnel, for keeping our residents and properties safe and secure every day.

Respectfully Submitted,
Shannon Cella, Executive Director
Carol Ramsey, Chairman
Deb Prew, Vice Chairman
Kim Graham, Treasurer
Linda Carroll, Member

Report of the Community Garden

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and the Citizens of Lenox:

The mission of the Lenox Community Garden (LCG) is to provide Lenox residents with a resource to plant, nurture and harvest produce and flowers in a mutually supportive environment. The garden aims to offer members and the town of Lenox positive nutritional, social and aesthetic benefits.

Accomplishing our mission

The LCG is a town of Lenox project located on town property adjacent to Lilac Park in downtown Lenox. It is under the direction of the Lenox Land Use Department with volunteer assistance from residents. It is a fenced plot consisting of 25 raised beds, each 4' x 8'; a locked shed with equipment; and a picnic table and benches. It is intended for the benefit of the entire Lenox community, with participation by master and novice gardeners. This beautifully maintained garden site will also offer visual enjoyment for visitors to Lenox.

There are two aspects to this project: the first is GARDEN. and the second is COMMUNITY.

Report of the Community Center

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen:

For more than seventy years, the Lenox Community Center has served as a cornerstone of the community — a place where residents of all ages come together to connect, learn, and support one another. Through programs, services, and community events, the LCC continues to strengthen connections across generations and enhance the quality of life in Lenox. With the support of dedicated staff, volunteers, community partners, and Town leadership, the Community Center remains committed to fostering a welcoming environment where community spirit thrives.

Mission Statement

The Lenox Community Center is committed to providing a safe and respectful environment for all who organize and participate in the programs and services offered through the center. Staff and the Board of Directors strive to maintain open communication while working in a proactive and productive manner to serve the evolving needs of the Lenox community.

COUNCIL ON AGING SERVICES

The Lenox Community Center proudly supports the town's older adults through programs and services that promote independence, wellness, and social connection. Transportation services help seniors reach medical appointments, grocery stores, and essential destinations. In 2025, the COA van traveled approximately 20,010 miles serving Lenox residents. Through our partnership with Elder Services, 1,550 congregate meals were provided at the Community Center. Additional services include SHINE Medicare counseling, AARP tax preparation, the Brown Bag program through the Food Bank of Western Massachusetts, foot care clinics, and a variety of wellness and exercise programs.

YOUTH & FAMILY PROGRAMMING

The Community Center continues to provide engaging opportunities for children and families throughout the year. The Gameroom Afterschool Program had 125 registered students in 2025, offering enrichment activities and a safe, supervised space for youth after school. In 2025, the LCC also reopened its Summer Camp, serving 61 individual children from 44 families, with many campers attending multiple weeks. Seasonal events such as Trunk-or-Treat, the Annual Tree Lighting, and the Egg Scramble continue to bring families together and strengthen community connections.

COMMUNITY OUTREACH & PARTNERSHIPS

The LCC works alongside local businesses, organizations, and volunteers to support residents in need. The Winter Coat Drive provides warm winter clothing to community members, while the Holiday Gift Giving Program supported 33 local children and their families. The Prom Pop-Up Shop at the Dr. Sax House offered students access to formal attire at no cost. The LCC also partnered with The Mount for NightWood and Bousquet Mountain for the Learn-to-Ski program.

PARKS & RECREATION

In partnership with the Lenox Youth Soccer Club, the LCC offered Mighty Kickers, a youth soccer program for children in grades K–2, during the spring and fall seasons. We also hosted T-Ball and Coaches Pitch baseball in the spring with the help of dedicated volunteer coaches. The Lenox Town Beach was open from Memorial Day through Labor Day and saw strong community use throughout the summer. In late 2025, the installation of a refrigerated ice-skating rink created a new winter gathering space for residents and was enjoyed daily from 8:00am to 9:00 PM.

LOOKING AHEAD

As the Community Center continues to evolve alongside the needs of Lenox residents, staff and leadership remain focused on expanding youth programming, strengthening services for older adults, and creating meaningful opportunities for community connection.

Respectfully Submitted,
Shannon O'Brien
Director, Lenox Community Center

Board of Directors
Sheri Gaherty, Chairperson
Francie Sheehan-Sorrentino, Clerk
Rose Fitzgerald-Casey
Peg Amendola
Kristie Prew
Jared Weber
Sara Jarvie

Report of Tri-Town Health Department

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen:

I hereby submit my annual report for the fiscal year 2025.

Following is a summary of our Public Health Prevention programs:

COVID-19 Pandemic: Fiscal Year 2025 was a continuation of combating COVID-19 like that of previous years. In FY25 we continue to offer several south County flu/COVID vaccination clinics (all 12 PHE towns) and administered 1,237 COVID vaccines, 1467 Flu vaccines, and 310 vaccines to those the age of 18 years of age, through 21 clinics. We also administered homebound vaccines. As the regional nursing program continues to grow, we will expand nursing services to meet the public health demands of our residents. We also distributed over masks and home tests for our residents. For a full breakdown by town on the number of vaccines offered in each town you can visit www.southernberkshirehealth.com

Regional Sharps Kiosk Program: the SBPHC has created a south county sharps recycling program in which location of sharps are located at specific locations in south County. Locations include TTHD Offices (now in Stockbridge) Otis Town Hall, and the Rural Recovery Center in Great Barrington. The SBPHC grant covers costs of service pickups. We have 11 of 12 PHE towns that have a sharps Kiosk.

Southern Berkshire Public Health Collaborative: In FY25 we were awarded \$515,000 to our regional grant to continue and build capacity and public health services for our 12 town SBPHC collaborative. The SBPHC governing board meets routinely and all meetings, agendas, minutes, meeting materials can be found at www.southernberkshirehealth.com and on the Tri-Town site.

Regional H5N1 Surveillance: The TTHD of Lee, Lenox, and Stockbridge investigated the communities' vulnerability to H5N1 avian influenza and decided to maintain active surveillance regarding this disease, considering it a potential threat. Outbreaks of polio in nearby New York state were also scrutinized but felt not to be an issue in Stockbridge.

Regional Household Hazardous Waste Program: In Fiscal year 2025 the HHW collection program offered one event due to rising costs but will offer two in FY26 after the assessments are adjusted to meet the rising costs of disposal. We served over 300 households registered for and we collected 4,554 gallons of chemical waste. The 17-town collaborative has been functioning for the past 18 years and in FY20, the Tri-Town Health District assumed administrative and operational responsibility to ensure it will continue for several more years. Smaller towns working together to create a sustainable program reflects great collaboration efforts and in addition protects the environment. We thank all of those involved in offering this service to the community.

MA Department of Public Health Workforce Standards: MA DPH has officially passed requirements for all state municipal public health employees to meet minimum standards of performance workforce standards, while most of the staff meet many standards the DPH will require a significant amount of new standards to meet the public health demand and reduce service inequity across the state to improve the public health delivery system.

Opioid Settlement Funds: The South County Recovery Center currently received Town of Lee Settlement funds to support our residents, who are active members at the Center, with a peer-led support system centered on non-clinical, community-based care. Individuals have access to trained recovery coaches who help them navigate personal goals and overcome barriers to long-term sobriety. The center also hosts diverse support groups and social activities, offering a stigma-free environment to rebuild healthy social connections. Furthermore, staff assist with essential resource navigation, connecting residents to vital re-entry, employment, substance use disorder treatment, and medical services within the Berkshire region and beyond.

Food Service Sanitation Program: The required mandated food service inspections are in full compliance with state standards up until COVID-19 hit. We made several operational adjustments in how to conduct virtual inspections.

Tobacco Retailer Training Program: The Tri-Town Tobacco Retailer certification program continues to be a success. We have continued to see reductions in store fines and suspensions due to ongoing training of store employees. In FY25, 329 vouchers were sold, and 147 clerks were trained

collecting \$3,275 in fees to sustain the program. For more information on the Retailer certification program, please visit www.tritownhealth.org.

We would like to take this opportunity to thank the Lee, Lenox and Stockbridge Boards of Health for their continued support and assistance and the Tri-Town Health Department staff, and volunteers for their dedication and public service in providing essential public health prevention programs to the communities we serve.

Permit Type	Issued
Bakery	8
Beach	3
Biological Wastes	1
Catering	10
Disposal Works Construction	13
Disposal Works Installer	15
Emergency Beaver Trapping Permits	1
Food Service	105
Frozen Dessert	7
Garbage Hauler	6
Milk/Cream Dealer	0
Milk/Cream Store	6
Milk/Cream Vehicle	1
Mobile Food	10
Motel/Hotel/Cabin/Trailer	15
Pool	40
Pasteurization	6
Rec. Children's Camp	2
Retail Food	10
Septage Hauler	8
Special Event Food Permit	26
Tanning Establishment	0
Tobacco	5
Well Permit	1

Inspections

Children’s Camps	3
Food Service/Retail	120
Housing Inspections/Reinspections	7
Misc. Complaints/Nuisances	14
Percolation Test Witness	13
Pool & Hot Tub Inspections	36
Special Events	15
T5 Witness	15

Water Testing

Ice Sampling	20
Pool & Hot Tub Testing	242
Quality Control	139
Water Testing Performed- Beaches	13
Well Sampling	1
Out of Town	5

Budget Revenue Information Fiscal 2025

Total budget:	\$253,537.89
Revenue generated:	\$79,965.61
Breakdown:	
Permits	\$ 66,464.90
Water Testing	\$ 7,462.22
Septic	\$ 4,914.47
Late Fee/Surcharge	\$ 1,124.02

Respectfully submitted,
James J. Wilusz, R.S.,
Executive Director/Registered Sanitarian

Report of the Department of Public Works

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

The mission of the Department of Public Works is to maintain and improve the Town's infrastructure: roads, water and wastewater treatment systems, water distribution system, wastewater collection system, stormwater collection system, parks, cemeteries and facilities. The daily responsibilities of water treatment, wastewater treatment, water and wastewater utility billing system, street maintenance and repair, snow and ice removal, cemetery maintenance and burials, mowing, brush cutting, tree removal, drain cleaning, trash collection, pavement markings, signage and care for our buildings are accomplished by a dedicated staff of fourteen whose combined efforts maintain the Lenox roads, infrastructure, buildings and its beautiful landscape.

There were thirty-nine snow and sixteen ice events in 2025 requiring responses to treat the Town roads and sidewalks. The events totaled 80.5 inches of snow.

The Water Division continues to leverage grant funding to help improve the Town's drinking water production and supply. The Department will continue to look for ways to reduce and conserve energy, while also saving the Town money.

Quality drinking water is one of Lenox's most important resources. Lenox needs to continue planning for additional sources of water, and take measures that help to ensure the high quality of water the residents come to expect. The Lenox Water Treatment plant produced 201,105,850 gallons of water this year. The Town added 9 new connections to our system and 470 back flow tests were performed. We continue to replace and upgrade water meters and water meter radios as needed, and four hydrants were repaired and replaced throughout town. Two thousand feet of watermain was replaced through Holmes Road and Holmeswood Terrace, and an additional 1,000 feet of watermain was added to complete a vital loop in our system. This redundant loop will improve water quality and ensure reliable service for our customers.

Water is a limited resource and the conservation and protection of existing sources needs to be a part of any municipal water system plan. Everyone needs to be aware of his or her water consumption and take steps to

minimize it. Make sure your home or business is leak free. Check your water meter when you are certain that no water is being used. If the meter reading changes, you have a leak. Repair dripping faucets. One drop per second wastes 2,700 gallons of water per year. Take shorter showers. Operate dishwashers and clothes washers only when they are fully loaded or set to the appropriate water level for the size of the load. Driveways and sidewalks should be cleaned by sweeping, not washing. Consider using a commercial car wash that recycles water. If you wash your own car, park on the grass and use a hose with an automatic shut-off nozzle. Never pour water down the drain when there is another use for it. Use it to water indoor plants or your garden. Every little bit helps and it will save you money.

The Wastewater Division began major upgrades to the wastewater treatment plant this past fall, a multi-year project designed to improve system efficiency and ensure regulatory compliance. The work includes updated equipment, improved treatment processes, and infrastructure enhancements to better serve the Town. Completion is scheduled for November 2027. Many thanks to the members of the Permanent Building Committee, project staff, and all others for their dedication, expertise, and hard work in bringing this project to fruition.

The Wastewater Division continues to look for ways to improve the collection system and how to treat the wastewater in the most effective and efficient way. We continue to map, monitor and inspect large sections of our collection system to help locate trouble areas in the hopes of reducing the inflow of ground water. Total wastewater flow collected at the Crystal Street Treatment Plant was 174,172,000 gallons for an average 477,000 gallons per day (gpd) out of a capacity of 1,190,000 gpd. Total wastewater flow pumped to the City of Pittsfield wastewater treatment plant from North Lenox was 50,366,418 gallons and an average of 137,990 gpd.

Wastewater flows will continue to increase as the town grows and as the system ages. Just as the conservation of drinking water can be a big factor in maintaining an adequate supply of quality drinking water and controlling costs, conservation can be a big factor in minimizing the amount of wastewater we have to treat resulting in cost savings for all system users. Sump pumps, floor drains, roof gutters, and leaking joints in pipes added an average of 64,198 gallons per day of otherwise clean water to the Crystal Street Wastewater Treatment Plant collection system during the past year. Once it is in the collection system it has to be treated along with the rest of the wastewater. Making sure your sump pump, floor drain, or roof

gutters do not discharge into your sewer pipe will significantly reduce the amount of wastewater we have to treat. Replace service pipes when it is determined they have defective joints. Fix leaking toilets and faucets. Take shorter showers. Operate dishwashers and clothes washers only when they are fully loaded or set the water level for the appropriate size of the load. If everyone contributes to some reduction in wastewater flow, we can conserve resources and save money at the same time.

The Cemetery Division performed 19 burials, at Mt. View Cemetery, New Lenox Cemetery, and Church on the Hill Cemetery. The burial records of the three Town cemeteries can be found on the Town's website, www.townoflenox.com. Click on Town Departments, Department of Public Works, Cemetery Division.

The Facilities Department keeps all town buildings and grounds safe, clean, and well-maintained. They collaborate with department heads and staff to address facility issues and prioritize necessary repairs. They are responsible for routine upkeep, seasonal tasks like snow removal and landscaping, and oversee improvements and upgrades to support the town's buildings.

During 2025, residents made 751 deliveries of leaves, brush and grass clippings to the Town's yard waste collection site located at the Crystal St. Wastewater Treatment Plant. The site was open eighteen Saturdays throughout the year. We encourage residents to make use of this service for disposal of leaves, grass clippings, small limbs, and Christmas trees.

Both the Water and Wastewater Divisions are "Enterprise Funds" which means they are designed to operate on funds received from rates and fees. A Cemetery fee schedule is also available.

I would like to say thank you to all Town Boards, Officers, and Departments for their continued collaboration and support of the Department. As always, a special thank you to the families of DPW staff who supported them through their long days and nights!

On behalf of the Department, I would also like to thank the residents of Lenox. We recognize how fortunate we are to work and serve every day in this community. Working alongside all of you, the Department of Public Works will continue to fulfill its mission to maintain and improve the Town of Lenox and its infrastructure.

Public Works Staff:

William J. Gop, Superintendent of Public Works

Neena Martino, Office Manager

Jeffery Carpenter, Assistant Superintendent

Daniel T. Kirby, Cemetery Foreman

Paul Vallee, Mechanic

Travis DelRatez, Water Department Foreman

Tyler Collins, Laborer/ Truck Driver

Steve Flanders, Laborer

Patrick Reagan, Water Treatment Plant Operator

TJ Smachetti, Laborer / Truck Driver

Jeffrey L. White, Wastewater Plant Foreman

Kevin Turner, Water Laborer

Scott Forbes, Wastewater Plant Operator

Brendan Armstrong, Laborer / Truck Driver

John Gaherty, Facilities

Respectfully Submitted,

William J. Gop

Superintendent of Public Works

Report of the Police Department

To the Honorable Members of the Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

The Lenox Police Department is committed to professional excellence in providing public safety services for the town and residents of Lenox through police patrols, criminal investigations, crime prevention activities, and community relations. The above-listed police personnel represent the current complement of officers and staff, and each of these law enforcement professionals is committed to portraying the highest standards of honesty, integrity and transparency. Thanks to their dedication to the community, professionalism, empathy, and courtesy community policing continues to be a priority for the department. Our thanks also go out to the Traffic Control Officers for their continued devotion to serving the public.

Our department continues to abide by the state mandated guidelines and policies for police departments throughout the Commonwealth of Massachusetts and will continue to integrate any new or updated guidelines and/or policies as soon as they become available.

On December 5, 2025, Chief Stephen E. O'Brien retired from the Police department after serving the town for a total of 32 years, 20 of which leading the department as its Chief of Police. His dedication and commitment to the police department and to those that live, work and travel through the Town of Lenox was beyond reproach. He is the epitome of a caring professional.

In addition to leading the Lenox Police Department, Chief O'Brien was committed to advancing law enforcement throughout the Commonwealth, so was an integral member of the Berkshire Law Enforcement Council, The Western Massachusetts Chiefs of Police and the Massachusetts Chiefs of Police Association. His involvement with these organizations helped to maintain the highest standards of training and he served as a mentor to numerous police officers and Chiefs throughout the Commonwealth. We wish Chief Stephen O'Brien a long and healthy retirement but most of all we thank him for all that he has done for this community and the profession of Law Enforcement. Chief O'Brien, you will be missed but have left a lasting legacy that will never be forgotten.

In 2025 the Lenox Police Department 7892 calls for service. These calls

for service include, but are not limited to responding to 231 reported motor vehicle accidents, 217 calls to assist citizens, 168 disabled motor vehicle calls, 219 calls to check the well-being of residents, 637 radar/traffic enforcement and motor vehicle stops, 161 disabled motor vehicles, 103 parking and enforcement complaints, 353 activated alarm calls, 53 shoplifting reports, 196 reports of suspicious activity, 370 burglar alarm activations, 178 incident reports, 455 citations issued and 118 arrests.

The officers assisted with or were involved in numerous community events. These events included “Read Across America” at the Morris Elementary School, “Trunk or Treat” Halloween event at the Lenox Community Center, The Ugly Sweater 5K run in the town of Lee to benefit the Special Olympics, the annual “Torch Run for the Special Olympics” in Cheshire, participated in the “Ruby Bridges” walk to school from Lilac Park with the students of Morris Elementary School, visited the Lenox Community Center and spoke with the Senior Citizens about various concerns within our community, borrowed the “Copsical” truck and served ice cream at the Lenox Community Center and Morris Elementary School, provided a police escort for Santa Clause at the annual Christmas Tree Lighting, provided traffic control at the Menorah Lighting in the center of town as well as in Lenox Dale, and on numerous occasions you would have found a Lenox Police Officer stopping at private lemonade stands throughout town.

Additionally, in 2025, the Lenox Police Department hosted three extraordinarily successful blood drives with outstanding participation! Thank you to Dianne Romeo and St. Ann’s Parish for the use of the church parking lot and facility. We hope to see you again donating in 2026!

I would like to take this opportunity to formally thank the Selection Committee, Board of Selectmen, and Town Manager, Jay Green, for affording me the honor and privilege to serve as the Chief of Police in Lenox. I would also like to thank Human Resources Director, Lyndsay Patenaude, for her professionalism and support throughout the transition process.

I have already witnessed the commitment, dedication, and professionalism demonstrated daily by the officers of this department and look forward to collaborating with them, as we move the department forward, and witnessing and recognizing their continued growth and accomplishments in the coming years.

I and the members of the Lenox Police Department recognize and appreciate the on-going support of the Select Board, Town Manager, Finance Committee and especially the citizens of Lenox and Lenox Dale. This department will continue to thrive because of you and your support and we thank you.

Mark L. Smith, Chief of Police

Michael T. Smith, Sergeant & SRT

William C. Colvin, Patrolman & School Resource Officer

Eric R. Kirby, Patrolman

Tyler W. Bosworth, Patrolman & Detective

B. Jake Stringer, Patrolman & Sex Offender Registry

Colin J. Benner, Patrolman

Kevin M. Shook, Patrolman & SRT

James C. Forgett, Patrolman

Marc E. Tousey, Patrolman

Dominic R. Bartini, Patrolman

Travis M. Derby, Patrolman

Dylan P. Tyer, Patrolman

Cameron Sibley, Reserve Patrol Officer

Marge Pero, Administrative Assistant

Respectfully submitted,

Mark L. Smith

Chief of Police

Report of the Fire Department

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

It is with great pride in this Department that I submit my 2025 Annual Report. The mission of the Lenox Fire Department is to protect the lives and property of those within the town by providing public safety education, performing fire safety inspections and providing emergency response services.

Requests for service-

The Lenox Fire Department responded to 2093 requests for assistance during 2025.

319 fire alarms, 20 fires, 63 service calls, 32 hazardous conditions, 1556 medical calls and 88 good intent calls (odor of smoke, steam believed to be smoke, etc.).

Stations and Equipment-

The Lenox Fire Department currently operates out of three fire stations that are strategically located throughout the town along with the recent addition of our much-awaited Public Safety Complex, housing the Police Department and Fire/EMS operations. This State of TheArt building will serve our operations for decades to come, and members are excited to occupy the space. This is done to reduce response times and allows us to better serve the citizens of the Town of Lenox. Our average response time (time of dispatch to time on scene of the incident) during 2025 was Dispatch to out the door, 1 minute and Dispatch to on the scene 6 minutes.

The Central Fire Station, built in 1910, is located at 14 Walker Street and serves as the department's headquarters and administrative offices. Equipment housed in the Central Station is Engine 1, a 2011 Seagrave Marauder II Rescue Pumper and Truck 5, a 1996 Darley – Quint (75-foot aerial ladder truck & pumper).

The Lenox Dale Fire Station, built in 1936, is located at 26 Elm Street and

houses Engine 6, a 2008 Seagrave Marauder II pumper. Engine 2, a 2001 Pierce Contender, reserve pumper and ISU-1, a 2007 Incident Support Trailer.

The New Lenox Fire Station, built in 1962, is located at 399 Pittsfield Road and houses Engine 3, a recently acquired 2018 Seagrave Marauder II, Truck 7, a 1999 Ford Brush Truck, Marine 1, a 19-foot, 5 horsepower rescue boat, Brush 1, a 2003 Honda, All Terrain Vehicle and Brush 2, a 2016 Polaris side by side UTV.

Training-

Throughout the year the Fire Department conducted weekly training to stay proficient in all aspects of fire suppression, rescue techniques and property preservation as well as State mandated training in Hazardous Materials, First Aid, Fire Investigation and Incident Management. This training was conducted both in house and with the Massachusetts Fire Academy. The Lenox Fire Department now has three members assigned to the Western Mass Technical Rescue Team, four members assigned to the Massachusetts Department of Fire Services Hazardous Materials Team and two members assigned to the Berkshire County Dive Team, a collaborative of Pittsfield Fire Department, Berkshire County Sheriff's Office and other County Police Agencies.

Fire Department Personnel-

On June 30, 2025, at 1pm, the Town of Lenox had a changing of the guard at the position of Fire Chief. Chief Christopher O'Brien a 39-year veteran of the Department, retired and "Passed the Helmet" to Deputy Chief Robert Casucci. Chief O'Brien shared a wealth of knowledge and experience to lead the Department through many a battle, including the Covid-19 Pandemic with confidence and devoted his career to maintain the legacy of the Lenox Fire Department that was established in 1909. Chief O'Brien's greatest feat was seeing through the development and construction of Lenox's new Public Safety Complex. Congratulations on a successful career Chief, enjoy retirement.

The Lenox Fire Department is currently made up of a Full Time Chief, Full Time EMS Director, 8 Career Firefighter/EMT's, 7 Part-time Relief Firefighter/EMT's and 35 Volunteer Firefighters. Our paid staff works out of the Central Fire Station and provides for two on duty FF/EMT's 24 hours a day seven days a week coverage.

Career Firefighter / EMT's

Robert Casucci, Chief	Jason Saunders, Deputy Chief
Dan Piretti, Captain	Larry Morse, FF/Paramedic
Matthew Williams, FF/Paramedic	Joshua Romeo, FF/Paramedic
Cameron Sibley, FF/Paramedic	Paige DiGrigoli, FF/Paramedic
Christopher Prew, FF/EMT	Matt Tyer, FF/Paramedic

Relief Firefighter / EMT's

Mike Zinchuk, Captain	Aurelien Telle, FF/EMT
Richard Shove, FF/EMT	Mychal Shove, FF/EMT
Jacob Soldato, FF/EMT	Kyle Marcantel, FF/EMT
	Kenneth Rosen, FF/EMT

Call / Volunteer Firefighters

Mitchell Arseneau, Firefighter	Matthew Boulais, Firefighter
Matthew Bradbury, Firefighter	Andrew Casucci, JR Firefighter
Emma Casucci, Firefighter	Bill Colvin, Deputy Chief
Steve Coon, Firefighter	Ethan Fairfield, Firefighter
Scott Forbes, Lieutenant	Bill Gop, Firefighter
Jackson Kamienski, JR Firefighter	Luke Kamienski, Firefighter
Owen Kamienski, JR Firefighter	Colman Keator, JR Firefighter
Jeffery Kane, Assistant Chief	Caleb Ketchen, JR Firefighter
John Kluka, Firefighter	Matt Lane, Firefighter
Jeff Lynch, Firefighter	Cam Marcantel, Firefighter
Lucas Maturevich, Firefighter	Justin Mercer, Firefighter
Jordan Meyer, Firefighter	Jason Miller, Firefighter
Michael Ozner, Firefighter	Chelcy Patel, JR Firefighter
Jim Prew, Firefighter	Brian-Logan Reid, Firefighter
Emmitt Shove, Firefighter	Gordon Shove, Firefighter
Katie Shove, JR Firefighter	Jason Sibley, JR Firefighter
Cayden Smachetti, JR Firefighter	TJ Smachetti, Firefighter
	Thomas Steben, Firefighter

Unfortunately, during 2025, our Department suffered the loss of retired Firefighters Gerald D. Borgo of the New Lenox Fire Company, Merton C. Hathaway and Richard "O.B. O'Brien, both Lenox Dale Fire Company and next door neighbors. Rest in peace and thank you for a job well done!

Prevention and Education-

This department was busy in many other facets of Public Safety such as Fire Inspections and Fire Education for our Senior Citizens and Schools. Our personnel continue to attend and receive training in the administering of the Massachusetts Fire Prevention Code.

The Fire Department would like to thank the Board of Selectmen and the citizens of the town for their continued support of our operations. As part of this support we are always looking for new members to fill our ranks. Please contact us if you are willing to volunteer and become a firefighter.

In closing, I want to sincerely thank all the officers and members of the Lenox Fire Department for their time and dedication. Also, without the support of the families of these brave men and women who respond at moments notice to assist others in need, the ranks of our volunteers would be greatly diminished.

Respectfully Submitted

Robert A. Casucci
Fire Chief
Lenox Fire Department

Report of the Library

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

2025 was another bustling year at the Library! We enjoyed 68,434 visits, checked out 65,941 items, and registered 263 people for new library cards. 8,583 people attended 296 programs.

The Lenox Library's mission is to connect our community to resources and programs that encourage lifelong learning and celebrate our collective history and culture. October 2025 provided a tremendous snapshot of our mission in action:

In celebration of Banned Books Week, we held our first all-day Banned Bookathon on October 8, 2025. Community members signed up for 15-minute timeslots to read from their favorite banned books, filling the reading room with diverse, important stories throughout the day. We were delighted that so many joined us in standing up for – and celebrating – our right to read, and look forward to making this an annual tradition.

Other adult programs included a screening and panel discussion of *Hear Me*, a documentary film featuring seven young people from Berkshire County who have been impacted by gun violence; YA (Young Adult) Book Club for Adults; weekly Tech Help sessions; Virtual Author Talks; and, of course, our book club, which now meets in four sections due to its popularity.

The Local History Department hosted a standing-room only event for Lenox graduate Dr. John Gennari's *The Jazz Barn: Music Inn, the Berkshires, and the Place of Jazz in American Life*, a book that explores how the predominantly white New England town of Lenox became a haven for African American musicians, and reveals the Berkshires as an important incubator not just of American literature and classical music but also of the Modern Jazz Quartet and Ornette Coleman's "new thing." The book includes iconic photos by Clemens Kalischer (1921-2018), whose works also were on exhibit in the Welles Gallery during October. In addition, Local History Librarian prepared her program, "Hutch and Cap: The First Two Fire Chiefs," that would be held on November 8 as part of the new Lenox Public Safety Complex Open House.

The Youth Department also brimmed with activities for both kids and teens. In addition to weekly Story Time and Baby Circle, we hosted a visit with author Roni Schotter for her book *Dragon Dreams* and offered our new sensory friendly Monthly Friends Gathering in partnership with Families Like Ours. For Halloween, we invited youngsters to dress in costume and travel to different stops in the Library for a special trick or treat story time and hosted a spooky afternoon making edible crafts for teens. Youth Librarian Ms. Vanessa and one of our Junior Librarians also represented the Library at the Community Center's Trunk or Treat. In addition, Vanessa presented a session, "Junior Librarians – A Youth Mentorship Program" at the October 2025 New England Library Association Conference "Soaring Together: Empowering Librarians to Lead."

And who can forget our Life of a Showgirl Par-Tay, when Swifties of all ages made friendship bracelets, paper rings, buttons, and bookmarks and tackled trivia to celebrate the release of Taylor Swift's latest album. We all enjoyed being "the baby of the family in Lenox" that day!

Last, but certainly not least, we installed two new Little Free Libraries in October to bring a little more joy, a little more connection, and even more books to our community. The two new Lenox Little Free Libraries — one located at Liston Park in Lenox Dale, the other at St. Helena's Chapel on New Lenox Road — joined the international movement to share books, bring people together, and create communities of readers. Phew, what a month it was!

We also had major Library staff news in 2025. Due to two maternity leaves, new substitute Library Associate Katy Holt joined the Library in January, followed by our new Youth Librarian Vanessa Justice in February. Ms. V, as kids have come to call her, holds a Master of Library and Information Science degree from Valdosta State University and previously served as Young Adult Librarian at the Berkshire Athenaeum in Pittsfield. She already has launched some exciting new initiatives, like our Junior Librarian and Read to a Librarian programs, and oversaw our most successful summer reading program on the books. 181 young readers turned in 404 K-12 tracker sheets representing 4,040 hours of reading and 110 ages 2-5 tracker sheets representing 201 hours of reading; that's more than 176 days' worth of reading in one summer!

In April 2025, we celebrated Local History Librarian Amy Lafave's 30 years at Lenox Library. From an initial part-time position at the front desk to her

current role as Local History Librarian – with a directorship in between – Amy has been an integral part of both the Library and the Town’s history. We honored Amy for her contributions to our community with tributes, a special musical performance, and some delicious cake. We truly are fortunate to have such an incredible team at the Library.

The Library also built even more community partnerships in 2025, working with: Ashland Public Library, Authors Guild Foundation, Berkshire Bird Observatory, Berkshire Community College, Berkshire County Kids Place, Berkshire Museum, Berkshire Music School, Berkshire Nursing Families, Berkshire South Regional Community Center, The Bookstore, Boston Athenaeum, Bottomless Bricks, Elizabeth Freeman Center, Families Like Ours, Lenox Community Center, Lenox Cultural Council, Lenox Department of Public Works, Lenox Fire Company, Lenox Library Association, Lenox Public Schools, Massachusetts Center for the Book, Morrill Memorial Library (Norwood, MA), The Mount, NAMI Berkshire County, Nutshell Playhouse, Shakespeare & Company, South Berkshire Kids, St. Helena’s Chapel, WAM Theatre, Watertown Free Public Library, and Yarmouth Town Libraries.

We look forward to continuing to bring joy and connection to our community in the coming year.

Respectfully submitted,
Katherine O’Neil, MLIS
Library Director

Staff for Calendar 2025:

Katherine O’Neil – Library Director
Amy Lafave – Local History Librarian
Christy Cordova – Information Librarian
Vanessa Dion – Collections Librarian
Vanessa Justice – Youth Librarian
Sara Jarvie – Youth Assistant
Megan Mackey – Circulation Coordinator
Anjani Nelson – Library Associate
Stephanie Storie – Library Associate
Katy Holt – Library Associate
Gene Lagonia – Facilities Manager

Report of the Cultural Council

To: The Honorable Board of Selectman and the Citizens of Lenox

RE: Distribution of Lenox Cultural Council grants for Calendar Year 2025

For 2025, the Lenox Cultural Council received an allocation of \$16,237 from the Massachusetts Cultural Council and the Town of Lenox. The Council received 49 grant applications for a total request of \$41,285. The Council awarded grants to 24 applicants in varying amounts for a total of \$16,200.

Applicant	Program Name
David Bates	A Celtic Celebration for Seniors
Berkshire Bach Society, Inc.	Messiah Sings!
Berkshire Children's Chorus	We are the Music Makers
Berkshire Lyric Theatre	Educational Programs and Concerts
Berkshire Music School	2025 Lenox Loves Music
Berkshire Pulse, Inc.	Storytelling Program for 3rd Graders
Birch Festival	Shostakovich Program
Boston University	BUTI Community Day
Cantilena Chamber Choir Corporation	Martin Luther King Celebration
Edith Wharton Restoration	Nightwood
Festival Latino of the Berkshires, Inc.	Festival Latino of the Berkshires
Greenagers, Inc.	Greenagers' Education and Stewardship
Lenox Library Association	Gaia Roots Drumming and Dance Performance
Jay Mankita	Chain reactions & Creative Contraptions Program
David Neill	A Jazzy Christmas Concert
Nutshell Playhouse, Inc.	Nutshell Playhouse at the Lenox Library
Olga Dunn Dance Company, Inc.	Edith Wharton Program
Jana Pfeiffer	The Juckets at School Program
Shakespeare & Company Inc.	2025 Fall Festival of Shakespeare
Tamarack Hollow Nature and Cultural Center, Inc.	Explore fauna and flora at Parson's Marsh
The Stockbridge Sinfonia, Inc.	The Stockbridge Sinfonia Summer Concert Series
Lara Tupper	Mary Oliver as Muse Program
Ventfort Hall Association	Children's Evening Story Hour
WAM Theater	WAM Theater's 2025 Community Engagement programming

The Lenox Cultural Council is part of a network of 329 Local Cultural Councils serving all 351 cities and towns in the Commonwealth. The LCC Program is the largest grassroots cultural funding network in the nation, supporting thousands of community-based projects in the arts, humanities and interpretive sciences every year. The state legislature provides an annual appropriation to the Mass Cultural Council, a state agency, which then allocates funds to each community.

The Lenox Cultural Council is grateful for the Town of Lenox's matching grant which provides us with the opportunity to fund an increased number of programs that foster a rich cultural life for Lenox residents. We are committed to supporting the work of local artists, cultural institutions, schools and groups with a focus on making cultural activities accessible and engaging to all. Visit www.mass-culture.org/Lenox for further information. The next grant deadline was in the October 2025 for grants to be awarded in 2026.

Decisions about which activities to support are made at the local level. If you would like to help ensure that there is a wide variety of arts and cultural programming in Lenox and the surrounding area please consider becoming a council member. For more information, please contact a council member.

Respectfully submitted,
Robin Kimbrough-Melton, Chair
Doug Pollock, Treasurer
Winnie Vahle, Secretary
Harriet Wetstone
Kimberly Duval
Gabriela Sheehan

Report of the Human Resources Department

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

Having a dedicated Human Resources function in municipal government is essential to recruiting, training, and retaining high-quality personnel, ensuring the effective delivery of public services. Human Resources manages complex legal compliance requirements, reduces organizational liability through the proper administration of policies and procedures, supports collective bargaining processes, and helps foster a positive and productive workplace culture.

The Town's full-time Human Resources Director plays a vital role in supporting all municipal employees by providing a centralized resource for personnel services while working in partnership with departments across the organization. The office focuses on service, efficiency, and professional competency in support of the Town's workforce and overall operational goals.

As a member of the Massachusetts Municipal Human Resources Association (MMHR), the Human Resources Director helps ensure compliance with state, federal, and local personnel laws and regulations. The office also serves as the central point of contact for human resources and personnel-related information for employees, departments, and leadership.

The Human Resources Office participates in and coordinates the hiring process for Town positions in varying capacities, depending on department-specific procedures and needs. In 2025, the Town experienced several retirements in key leadership roles, including the Police Chief and Fire Chief. The Human Resources Director played an integral role in these transitions, serving on the hiring committees for both internal and external searches.

During 2025, the Town successfully filled nine major full-time benefited positions, including Town Manager, Land Use Director, Youth Librarian, Police Chief, Fire Chief, Town Clerk, LCC Program Coordinator, and two Department of Public Works Highway Laborer positions. In addition, numerous part-time employees were hired to support the operations of several Town departments.

The Human Resources Office also works to provide employees and retirees with comprehensive and cost-effective health insurance benefits. The Human Resources Director serves on the board of the Town's insurance partner, Berkshire Health Group, helping to develop strategic approaches to manage costs while maintaining the quality of coverage.

As healthcare costs continue to rise, the insurance market remains volatile. In advance of last year's renewal, costs materially exceeded available funding, and Berkshire Health Group made the difficult decision to implement a 16% increase in order to stabilize the Trust. This challenge reflects a broader trend being experienced by municipalities across the Commonwealth. As we approach the upcoming renewal cycle, Berkshire Health Group and its member communities once again face the need to make careful financial decisions to ensure the long-term sustainability of the program.

The Human Resources Office remains committed to supporting Town employees and leadership by providing responsive service, maintaining compliance with evolving employment regulations, and promoting sound personnel practices. Through collaboration with departments and continued attention to workforce needs, the office strives to help the Town attract and retain talented employees who serve our community every day.

Respectfully submitted,
Lyndsay Patenaude
Human Resources Director

Report of the Historical Commission

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

During 2025, the Historical Commission focused on a range of issues, some continuing from prior years.

Endangered Properties: In keeping with its mission to preserve and protect the Town's historic assets, the Commission maintained a watchful eye on several endangered properties, including Spring Lawn (10 Kemble St., c. 1904), Sedgwick Family Farmhouse (12 East Street, c. 1780), Mahanna Barn (50 Church Street, c. 1888), the abandoned schoolhouse (c. 1843) on the Eastover estate, and the Loomis-Goodell house (51 Housatonic Street, c. 1870). One property on last year's list—the Cook Family House (a.k.a. Elijah Northrup House, Meadow Place, or Winstanley House, 114 Main St., c. 1790)—was removed after it was acquired by a new owner with plans to preserve and renovate the property.

Demolition Requests: The Commission approved demolition requests for outbuildings at 106 Cliffwood St., 42 Walker St., and 45 West Street.

Demolition Delays: A demolition delay imposed several years ago at 12 East Street remains in effect because it has not been acknowledged by the owner despite repeated efforts to establish communication. In July, the Commission approved a demolition delay for the house at 51 Housatonic St., and a public meeting on the matter was held on July 28. The property has since been sold and the Commission is awaiting a discussion with the new owner on plans for the building.

Minimum Maintenance Bylaw: The Commission worked on a draft bylaw calling for minimum maintenance of historically significant buildings. The draft bylaw is similar to those in effect in other Massachusetts towns and is aimed at preventing “demolition by neglect” when owners do not provide sufficient maintenance to keep their properties from becoming at risk of demolition. The draft bylaw has been discussed with senior Town officials and department heads, as well as the Town's outside counsel, and the Commission hopes it will be approved at a Town meeting in 2026.

Church on the Hill Cemetery: The deteriorating condition of the cemetery prompted the Commission to endorse an application to the Community Preservation Committee for funding to develop a long-term plan for the facility. The CPC declined to fund the proposal but ensuing discussions

with Town officials indicate that the project will be funded in the next Town budget.

Westinghouse Street Lights: Since 2010, 49 replicas of historic lights donated more than a century ago by George Westinghouse have been installed in the village. Over time some have suffered from the effects of weathering, and the Commission wishes to thank the Department of Public Works for providing monitoring and repair of affected lights. Six lights were repaired in 2025 and five more are slated for repair in 2026.

Historic Building Plaque Program: Thirty-three plaques have been installed since the program started in 2010 but relatively few in recent years. In 2025, the Commission sought to revitalize the program, which includes free replacement of weatherworn plaques. Volunteer Jim Biancolo prepared a brochure describing the program and a simplified application for interested property owners. He also created a database to support encouraging property owners in the historic district to consider purchasing a plaque in 2026.

Certified Local Government (CLG) Program: In August, the Massachusetts Historical Commission (MHC) turned down the Town's application for CLG status, which offers financial benefits to qualifying member towns. At the same time, MHC encouraged the Town to reapply after it takes steps to meet certain required criteria.

Personnel Changes: During the year Lucy Kennedy resigned from the Commission after 12 years of distinguished contributions; two long-time members, Jan Chague and Kimberly Duval, became alternate members; and two alternate members, Ray Kirby and Joan Bruno stepped down. Richard Gregg joined as a member in October. As chair, I wish to thank present and former members and alternates for their commitment and service toward preserving the historical character of the Town.

Respectfully submitted,

Olga Weiss, Chair
Jan Chague
Davis Dyer
Rick Gregg
Tom Romeo
Jan Chague, alternate
Kimberly Duval, alternate
Jim Biancolo, volunteer

Report of the Conservation Commission

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

The Conservation Commission is composed of seven volunteer members appointed by the Board of Selectmen, there is one vacancy currently. The Commission administers and enforces the state Wetlands Protection Act (WPA) and the Scenic Mountain Act (SMA). In that capacity, the Commission processes applications to perform work in and near the wetlands, flood plains, rivers, banks, surface waters, other resource areas and the mountain regions. The intent of the WPA is to control activities that involve filling, excavating, or otherwise altering wetlands that can impair their many valuable functions.

The intent of the SMA is to protect watershed resources and preserve the natural scenic qualities of the mountain region.

Under the Wetland Protect Act, the Commission processed five Notices of Intent, eight Determination of Applicability requests and six Certificate of Compliance requests. There were no filings under the Scenic Mountain Act for 2025. Projects included commercial upgrades, municipal infrastructure improvements, invasive species management, trail projects, and residential additions.

Each application requires a public hearing or public meeting, review of plans, a site visit and an Order of Conditions or Determination of Applicability. Certificates are issued after the Commission conducts site visits to assure adherence to the Orders of Conditions.

Each filing is also reviewed by MassDEP, who sometimes issues comments. The Commission may issue special conditions as well. Site visits are also conducted in some cases of new construction or demolition to ensure proper clearance from identified wetlands, prior to the issuance of Certificates of Compliance and in response to questions raised by concerned citizens.

The Commission managed four conservation properties, including Post Farm, Edith Wharton Park, and conservation land on Undermountain Road and East Dugway Road.

The Conservation Commission meets on the first and third Thursday at 7:30 p.m. at the Town Hall in the Land Use Meeting room. In 2025, they held sixteen meetings.

Respectfully submitted,
Neal Carpenter, Chairman
David Lane
Vince Ammendola
Rosemary Fitzgerald Casey
Richard Ferren
Mark Smith

Report of the Affordable Housing Trust

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

The Purpose of the Trust – its mission – is to provide for the preservation and creation of affordable housing in the Town of Lenox for the benefit of low- and moderate-income households: affordable for present and future members of our community and our workforce in the Berkshire region. The seven member Lenox Affordable Housing Trust is appointed by and includes a Select Board member. All Trust funds are overseen by the Lenox Town Treasurer.

The Lenox Affordable Housing Trust was the first Trust with this purpose formed in Berkshire County in 2009. We encourage residents and others interested in the future of a thriving community and concerned about housing affordability to attend Trust meetings and become active members and advocates.

In the last calendar year the Lenox Trust explored initiatives or actions taken by other organizations and communities in the region, scheduled site visits, and hosted public meetings, as well as considered the possibility of new projects.

Brett Roberts (Berkshire Regional Planning Commission) presented details on BRPC's Home Modification Loan Program and its funding for home repairs or renovations that would make accessibility improvements allowing individuals with disabilities or seniors (60+) to live independently at home. Loans: up to \$50,000 for homeowners; \$1,000 to \$30,000 for manufactured/mobile homes. Terms: 0% interest with no monthly payments; a lien is placed on the property and the loan repaid when the home is sold or transferred (similar to CDBG terms). Further details on Eligible Projects: BRPC website & Lenox Town Hall brochure holder.

The Trust continues to support the Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) program which this past year in partnership with the Town of Lee provided up to \$70,000 to 11 income-qualifying homeowners in need of funds for critical home repairs: 8 Lenox and 3 Lee households worked

with contractors and Program Mgr. Dawn Odell Lemon. The Lenox Select Bd. is again applying for this program with the Town of Sandisfield. The waiting list continues to grow as homeowners view the opportunity for funding needed repairs: lead remediation, new windows or doors, electrical or plumbing work, new roof, siding or steps, septic systems, handicap accessibility, etc. The value of this program? Approximately \$560,000 in funds for home repairs that benefit the Lenox housing stock – for current and future homeowners. The Trust voted to cover the contingency fee (\$25,000) for this important housing rehab program. Trust members have discussed attempting to mirror the CDBG rehab program with a local program funded by the Trust.

The Trust's long-term commitment (11 years) to closing the gap for new homebuyers looking for a residence in Lenox continues with our First Time Homebuyer Assistance Program. Lenox welcomed 1 new income-qualified homebuyer eligible to take advantage of the program – an income limit of 100% and up to \$20,000 grant funding. While home prices and interest rates challenge all buyers in recent years in competition with cash purchases, the local workforce has faced a tough market for homebuying. The First Time Homebuyer Assistance Program brochure is available in Town Hall, on the Trust website, and at local realty offices and banks.

Trust members also discussed initiatives undertaken by the Town of Egremont and the CDC of So. Berkshires, meeting with Lenox resident Jim Harwood (Dir. - CDC of So. Berkshire) who provided insights and detailed planning for the Egremont affordable duplex development on town-owned land. A follow-up conversation with Egremont resident Doug Mishkin, a key activist for affordable housing, about their duplex plan and other initiatives Egremont is pursuing to improve affordable housing opportunities for current members of the workforce in the south part of the county contributed to discussions on property acquisitions and potential affordable home ownership projects for Lenox.

For the 3rd year, the Trust requested a Special Town Meeting Warrant Article which passed overwhelmingly on November 6, when citizens approved \$49,102.83 for Trust use, a 25% share of the Short Term Rental funds (STR) certified as free cash. This request for a share of the STR funds will likely continue, as residential housing has become increasingly

commercialized lodging use. Unfortunately, this funding is now trending downward, rather than increasing as was expected.

The Trust voted to add an additional \$200,000 to our funding (\$100,000) committed to the 238 Pittsfield Rd. Pennrose affordable housing development approved by the Zoning Bd. of Appeals and applying for state funds in 2025. The Trust's additional funding supported the need for a show of strong "community support," a vital condition for state funding of these developments, units which will now fulfill the town's goal to meet the state's 10% affordable housing minimum.

In May the Trust planned a Pennrose "The Forge" site visit, inviting members of other town boards and officials to tour the not-quite-completed affordable housing buildings and grounds. The Trust also hosted a public meeting at Town Hall on May 14 with Pennrose staff on the rental and lease-up process, and welcomed a large crowd interested in the application process for housing. Pennrose's Ashley Persinger and Rebecca Schofield explained the application, vetting, and lottery process ("Fair & Affirmative Marketing") required by the state for these developments.

The Trust has supported these Comprehensive Permit 40B developments which will bring our Subsidized Housing Inventory (SHI) closer to the mandated 10% of year-round housing in a community as affordable for families and singles, seniors, and our workforce. The 2nd Pennrose mixed income rental development (238 Pittsfield Rd.) will enable income-qualifying applicants interested in the 1, 2 or 3 bedroom units to live in Lenox and will help Lenox pass the 10% affordability threshold. Both projects satisfied the Lenox Zoning Board of Appeals (ZBA) review and rigorous Comprehensive Permit decision-making process.

The Trust again submitted a proposal to the Community Preservation Committee for funding. CPC's are considered a major source of funding for affordable housing initiatives in communities statewide. The application requested \$300,000 for land acquisition from its Community Housing Purpose resources. \$600,000 previously expended by the CPC for the purchase of the "Sawmill" site for "community housing" had been returned to the CPC due to its use for the new Lenox Public Safety Complex. (As of January, 2026, the FY 27 Trust request for funding was denied.)

The Trust voted to support a request from Construct for continued funding

for rental assistance, and for funds to advertise and highlight their regional rental assistance program – and available rental assistance and Trust initiatives on affordability.

The Trust voted to expend \$25,000 - \$28,000 (contingent on costs of a community survey) funding for a required update of the Housing Production Plan (HPP) with the goal of increased advocacy and strategic plans for more affordable housing – home ownership and workforce housing opportunities in Lenox. The HPP update is underway with a focus on public participation in Visioning Sessions, and spirited discussions on strategies to gain housing affordability.

Trust members have engaged in broad discussions of initiatives that would bring about more affordable housing opportunities: availability of town or state-owned land, purchase and sale of existing houses deed-restricted for affordability, supportive funding available for ADU's, increasing the Homebuyer Assistance grants, outlining goals for acquiring properties for future affordable house/duplex building, etc. The Trust reviewed housing sales data provided by Sandy Carroll (Berkshire Bd. of Realtors) with input from member Jackie McNinch on the challenge of rising home prices.

The Trust awaits construction activity permitted on the Blantyre property, which will trigger future property acquisitions specified in the deeded Residential Inclusionary Development Agreement: one single family house on Patterson Rd., and four 1-acre parcels as the development is completed. Trust members held an informal site visit to view the house and its location, topography, etc., and spoke with neighbors on Patterson Rd. Trust members also convened an informal site visit at a property advertised for sale on East St.

The Trust has also voted to formally ask the Bd. of Assessors and Select Bd. to consider a property tax exemption for property owners who offer long term rentals to income-qualified tenants – which has been implemented in Egremont, and could also provide housing for local workers in Lenox.

Trust Agendas and Minutes are now routinely posted to our website. The Trust website has also been undergoing changes adding new information in both English and Spanish, allowing the public better access to helpful

resources available for community housing. We anticipate additional changes to better serve the needs of would-be residents looking for housing affordable and available in Lenox.

The Trust meets on the first Monday of the month at 5pm in the Land Use Room in Town Hall.

We would like to acknowledge the work of (now former) Treasurer Chris Fenton, who resigned as a result of his move out of town, and former State Rep. Smitty Pignatelli who also recently resigned.

Respectfully submitted:

Trust Members

Kate McNulty-Vaughan, Chair

Don Weber, Clerk

*Chris Fenton – Resigned 2025

Jackie McNinch

Marybeth Mitts, Treasurer

Smitty Pignatelli

Olga Weiss

Report of the Historic District Commission

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

The Lenox Historic District was established in 1975 to promote the educational, cultural, economic and general welfare of the public through the preservation and protection of the distinctive characteristics of buildings and places significant in the history of Lenox, or significant for their architecture, and the maintenance and improvement of settings for such buildings and places and the encouragement of design compatibility therewith.

The Historic District is administered by the Lenox Historic District Commission, a five-member oversight board appointed by the Board of Selectmen. The Historic District Commission applies the Historic District Bylaw to prevent incongruous alterations.

The Historic District is characterized by a variety of streetscapes made up of buildings of many different types, styles or designs, sizes, and settings. Its architecture reflects a range of historical developments, from the early period of Lenox as the county seat through the Gilded Age with its “summer cottages” and important residential and commercial architecture, to the late 1930s when Tanglewood furthered Lenox’s reputation as a cultural destination. The diversity is also evident in the variety of building types. In each period of the village’s development, and for each architectural style, different types of buildings are found; public buildings, simple residences and grand cottages, commercial buildings and commercial blocks. The diversity of the Historic District is also found in the variety of building sizes. The result is a Historic District that is characterized by its diversity, not its uniformity. While most of the Historic District’s architecturally and historically significant buildings were constructed by 1923, the appearance and use of many buildings in the Historic District continued to evolve in the following decades. These changes are now an important part of the Historic District.

2025 Historic District Commission Members:

Jason Berger, Aurelien Telle, Pat Jaouen, Ken Fowler, Peggy Ammendola, and David Joseph.

During 2025, the Historic District Commission reviewed applications for new construction, remodeling, alterations, renovations, window replacements, and signage. The Commission updated the Historic District Guidelines and worked with the Building Commissioner to educate the community regarding the Historic District Guidelines and Bylaws.

The Historic District Bylaw is enforced by the Building Commissioner. Chairperson Jason Berger continues to act as the Commission's liaison to the Building Department in order to facilitate better communication and consistency between the two entities.

The Historic District Commission meets at the call of the chairperson at Town Hall or via Zoom. Meetings are often held on the first and/or third Tuesday of the month.

Respectfully submitted,
Jason Berger,
Chairperson, Lenox Historic District Commission

Report of the Zoning Board of Appeals

Robert Fuster, Jr., Chair
John Simons (Associate)
Kimberly Duval (Resigned 9/15/25)
Donna Pignatelli (Associate)
Christine Conklin (Associate)

Shawn Leary Considine, Clerk
Albert Harper
Jedd Hall (Associate)
Arthur Oliver
Daniel Schenker

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

The Zoning Board of Appeals is a quasi-judicial body that operates under the authority of Chapter 40A of the General Laws of the Commonwealth for the purpose of promoting the health, safety, convenience, and general welfare of the Town of Lenox. Residents or businesses seeking relief in the form of a special permit or a variance initiate virtually all matters that come before the Board. We endeavor to make decisions that are timely, transparent, and consistent as allowed within the Lenox Zoning Bylaw. We also endeavor to create an environment where applicants are treated fairly and the entire staff works to that end.

The Zoning Board of Appeals is a nine-member board, appointed by the Selectmen. Five are regular members and four serve as alternates. The board is currently seeking two alternate members to fill the board.

The Board issues decisions on the following:

- Special permits as allowed under the Zoning Bylaw
- Variances from the requirements of the Zoning Bylaw
- Comprehensive permits under Chapter 40B of the General Laws of the Commonwealth
- Site plan approval of the Zoning Bylaw
- Appeals from the decisions of the Inspector of Buildings

In 2025, the Lenox Zoning Board of Appeals reviewed applications for 9 special permits, one of which was denied and one of which was withdrawn, 2 special permit modifications, 4 variances, one of which was denied, and 1 site plan review waiver. These involved a wide range of requests including large commercial investments and smaller scale investments such as accessory dwelling units and modifications of residences.

The Board normally meets on the first and third Wednesday of each month at 7:00 pm. We welcome new members if you are interested in serving the Town in this way.

Respectfully submitted,
The Lenox Zoning Board of Appeals

Report of the Superintendent of Schools

To the Honorable Members of the Board of Selectmen and the Citizens of Lenox:

The United States Constitution does not mention education. Not once. The framers left it to the states to determine whether schooling would be a public obligation or a private endeavor.

Massachusetts chose to clearly and boldly enshrine education. In 1780, our Commonwealth adopted a Constitution that declared it the duty of government to “cherish the interests of literature and the sciences” and to support public schools. That word “cherish” is not accidental. It implies active care, sustained attention, and moral responsibility. Education in Massachusetts was not treated as optional infrastructure. It was embedded as a civic promise.

That promise remains the foundation of Lenox Public Schools. We understand that public education in Massachusetts is not simply a service we provide; it is a constitutional duty we fulfill. John Adams, author of the Massachusetts Constitution, argued that an informed citizenry was vital to preserving our rights and liberties. The strength of our democracy depends upon informed, thoughtful, capable citizens. Schools are where that capacity is cultivated, deliberately and daily.

In Lenox, we continue to honor the spirit of what John Adams wrote 246 years ago. We remain committed to inclusive practices, early intervention systems, expanded academic opportunities, and responsible fiscal management. We recognize that trust is earned and must be protected.

The School District is legally and morally obligated to provide a free and appropriate public education to every student. When the needs of a student exceed the programs and services we can reasonably provide in-house, we must secure an appropriate out-of-district placement. While the tuition and transportation costs associated with these placements impact the budget, they ensure that students receive the specialized instruction and supports required by law and necessary for their success.

The enrollment for the 2025–2026 school year is 762 students, including 17 Preschool students in our early learning program at Morris Elementary School. Morris serves 307 students in Kindergarten through Grade 5. Lenox Memorial Middle School enrolls 194 students in Grades 6–8, and Lenox Memorial High School serves 244 students. Approximately 41% of

our students attend through the Massachusetts School Choice program, strengthening both our classrooms and our fiscal sustainability.

Lenox Public Schools employs the equivalent of 87 full-time instructional professionals. Our student-to-teacher ratio remains low, allowing us to respond with precision to individual student needs. This past year, the district again earned the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education's highest accountability designation: "Meeting or Exceeding Targets." 100% of the Lenox Memorial High School Class of 2025 graduated.

These outcomes do not occur by accident. They are the result of careful stewardship, high expectations, and the collective efforts of educators who attend to what might seem like small details but which, together, define a culture. Excellence is not one sweeping initiative. It is hundreds of thoughtful decisions made each day in classrooms, offices, the cafeteria, the theater, and on the athletic fields.

It is my honor to work with an extraordinary team, which includes classroom teachers, school counselors, adjustment counselors, nurses, paraprofessionals, administrators, administrative assistants, custodians, cafeteria staff, coaches, bus drivers, volunteers, and School Committee members. Their work ensures that belonging and academic excellence advance together. Students thrive when they feel safe, supported, and valued, or, in the words of John Adams, "cherished."

Lenox Memorial Middle and High School

Dr. Jeremiah Ames, Principal

Lenox Memorial Middle and High School strives to provide each student with a wide range of academic and extracurricular opportunities in a safe, nurturing environment that fosters each student's maximum potential.

New this year, the Lenox Memorial Middle and High School Competency Determination (CD) policy establishes that students demonstrate readiness for graduation by successfully completing required high-school coursework and meeting mastery standards within those courses. Students do this by achieving a passing grade and completing final assessments in core academic areas, including English, mathematics, science, and (for the Class of 2027 and beyond) U.S. history. The policy also outlines provisions for students with disabilities, English learners, late-enrolling students, and an appeals process. This competency-based system replaces the former requirement that students pass high-school MCAS exams to graduate. Instead of a single standardized test, graduation eligibility is now determined through successful completion and demonstrated mastery of aligned coursework.

Lenox Memorial Middle and High School strives to ensure that every graduate is well prepared for life after high school. Through strong academics and applied learning opportunities, students develop the skills and experiences needed to pursue a variety of post-secondary goals. In the spring of 2025, 64% of Lenox graduating seniors entered four-year colleges, 24% went on to two-year colleges, and the remaining 12% entered the workforce, joined the military, or sought post-secondary vocational training. Vocational education is an option for Lenox students through a partnership with the Pittsfield Public Schools, which allows them to attend Taconic High School vocational programs and earn diplomas or certificates. Additionally, LMMHS's Internship Program enables juniors and seniors to spend up to half of their school day interning with local businesses while continuing their academic program on campus. Students may also take advantage of dual-enrollment opportunities at MCLA and BCC to earn college credits while still enrolled at LMMHS.

Lenox students continue to demonstrate strong academic achievement across multiple measures of college readiness and performance. During the 2024-2025 school year, Lenox students performed well above state averages on the Next Generation MCAS. In English Language Arts, 82% of LMMHS 10th graders exceeded or met expectations, compared to 51% statewide. 67% of 10th graders met or exceeded expectations in Math, as opposed to 46% across Massachusetts. A total of 56 students took 80 Advanced Placement exams in subjects including 2D Art, 3D Art, Biology, Calculus, Computer Science, Environmental Science, French, Latin, Spanish, Physics, and Statistics. All sophomores take the PSAT and all juniors take the SAT together at the school.

LMMHS features a range of clubs and activities at both the Middle and High School levels, including Cine Club, Drama Club, Fitness Club, High School Art Club, High School Student Council, High School Yearbook, History Club, Genders & Sexualities Alliances (MS and HS), HS Robotics, Improv Club (Poorly Timed Sneezes), JAM Club, Kripalu Yoga, Latin Club, Math Club, Middle School Spanish Club, Mock Trial, Mountain Bike Club, National Art Honor Society, National Honor Society, Peer Education, Peer Tutoring, Photography Club, Pokemon Club, and the Quiz Team/As Schools Match Wits. Students have also traveled to destinations including Spain, Washington DC, New York City, Mass MoCA, The Clark, The Norman Rockwell Museum, and Pleasant Valley Sanctuary.

In the fall of 2024 LMMHS students performed Midsummer Night's Dream as part of the Shakespeare & Company Fall Festival, followed by a Middle School production of Henry V through the Shakespeare & Company Middle School Residency program. The high school staged a production of the musical Freaky Friday in the spring of 2025. Middle Schoolers performed in the musical Adams Family in the spring as well.

Lenox's athletic programs have grown in recent years, with steady increases in participation. Coaches and student-athletes continue to demonstrate good sportsmanship and engage the community through clinics, volunteer projects, and other initiatives. All athletic teams have recently qualified for either State or Western Mass postseason play. Lenox maintains cooperative sports agreements with Lee Public Schools, Berkshire Hills Regional School District and Pittsfield Public Schools. LMMHS offers the following sports:

- FALL: Boys Soccer (host team w/ Lee), Girls Soccer, Boys & Girls Cross-Country Running, Golf, Crew (non-MIAA), Volleyball, Football (w/ Lee), Unified Basketball Team
- WINTER: Boys & Girls Basketball, Cross-Country Skiing, Alpine Skiing (host team w/ Lee), Swimming (w/ MMRHS), Hockey (coop w/ Taconic), Wrestling (coop w/ Taconic)
- SPRING: Baseball, Softball, Tennis, Track (host team w/ Lee), Boys Lacrosse, Girls Lacrosse (w/ Lee), Crew (as a club)

The strength of LMMHS programming described above reflects the generous support of the Lenox community. We are proud to be a vital part of the town and of the shared investment in its young people.

Morris Elementary School

Brenda J. Kelley, Principal

It is with great pride and gratitude that I share this year's report with the Lenox community. This year, I was honored to be named the Massachusetts Distinguished Principal by the National Association of Elementary School Principals. While I am deeply appreciative of this recognition, it reflects the dedication, professionalism, and commitment of the exceptional staff at Morris Elementary School. This honor truly belongs to our entire school community.

I also extend my sincere appreciation to the Town of Lenox for its continued support of our students, families, and educators. Your partnership allows Morris Elementary School to thrive and ensures that our students have access to high-quality learning experiences in a supportive environment.

School Leadership

Morris's Assistant Principal, Holly Soules, is now in her second year at Morris Elementary School. Holly brings seventeen years of experience in education and continues to play a key role in strengthening our school climate and behavioral supports.

One of Ms. Soules' primary focuses this year has been advancing our Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports (PBIS) framework as Morris enters its third year of implementation. She has led the development of the

PBIS Check-In/Check-Out program, providing additional structure and support for students who benefit from targeted behavioral interventions. Ms. Soules prioritizes building strong relationships with students and their families. Her commitment to educating the “whole child” ensures that both the academic and social-emotional needs of students are addressed while promoting a school culture grounded in equity, inclusion, and mutual respect.

Academic Programs and Student Support

Morris Elementary School uses a comprehensive system of assessments to monitor student growth and identify areas where additional support may be needed. Students are assessed three times each year in English Language Arts (ELA) and Mathematics. After each benchmark period, classroom teachers collaborate with Reading and Math Specialists, the Title 1 Coordinator, and Special Education staff to review results and determine appropriate instructional supports.

Students requiring additional assistance receive targeted interventions and ongoing progress monitoring to ensure that instructional strategies are effective and responsive to their needs.

In accordance with state requirements, Morris continues to conduct dyslexia screenings using an approved early literacy assessment tool. When a student performs significantly below benchmark expectations, families are notified within 30 school days and invited to meet with school staff to review results and discuss next steps in supporting their child’s literacy development.

Literacy Instruction

Our literacy program emphasizes strong foundational skills while fostering a love of reading and writing.

Students in grades K–2 participate in the Wilson Foundations program, which builds phonemic awareness, decoding strategies, sight word recognition, and foundational grammar skills.

In grades 3–5, students continue developing vocabulary and word analysis through structured word study using Spelling Connections and Foundations. The Title 1 program currently serves 53 students in reading and 43 students in mathematics, with 27 students receiving support in both areas. Instruction is provided in small groups of one to three students, allowing for individualized attention and skill-based instruction.

Classroom teachers differentiate literacy instruction through flexible grouping and standards-based lessons. Students engage with a wide variety of texts and participate in vocabulary development, comprehension strategy instruction, and structured written responses.

Writing instruction incorporates multiple resources, including the Framing Your Thoughts program. Students learn the stages of the writing process and produce narrative, informational, and opinion writing with opportunities for feedback, revision, and conferencing.

Science and Mathematics

Amplify Science continues to be fully implemented in grades kindergarten through five. Through hands-on investigations, students explore real-world problems while developing scientific reasoning and problem-solving skills aligned with grade-level standards.

In mathematics, the school continues to use the 2023 edition of Go Math! as its core instructional program. Additional intervention resources, including Do the Math and Connecting Math Concepts, are used to address specific skill gaps and strengthen conceptual understanding.

Staff members meet formally three times per year in Data Team meetings to analyze student performance and determine next instructional steps. Intervention programs such as Literacy Footprints, Leveled Literacy Intervention, Flyleaf Foundational Skills Builder, and Heggerty Phonological Awareness are also utilized to support literacy development based on student data.

2025 MCAS Results

The 2025 MCAS results show that Morris Elementary School continues to perform above state averages in overall achievement. Students across grade levels demonstrated typical to high typical growth, reflecting the strong instructional practices and consistent progress taking place throughout the school.

Analysis of the data highlights several areas of strength, including overall academic achievement and positive growth trends among students. The information gathered also helps guide our ongoing efforts to strengthen instruction and ensure that all learners continue to make meaningful progress.

By reviewing classroom-level, subgroup, and item-specific data, staff members refine Tier 1 instructional practices and evaluate supports to ensure that every student receives the appropriate level of instruction and intervention. Maintaining clear communication with students about their academic goals and progress remains an important focus as we continue to support their growth and success.

Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports (PBIS)

Over the past three years, Morris Elementary School has implemented Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports (PBIS), a proactive and

systematic approach to school-wide discipline based on the Response to Intervention (RtI) model.

PBIS promotes positive behavior, improves school safety, and establishes a learning environment that is predictable, consistent, and supportive for all students.

Our school-wide expectations are represented by the acronym **ROAR**:

- **Rise to the Challenge**
- **Own Your Actions**
- **Always Work Together**
- **Respect Yourself and Others**

Students are explicitly taught these expectations and recognized for demonstrating them through ROAR tickets and schoolwide celebrations. This year, Morris strengthened its support system by establishing a Tier 2/3 support team that meets weekly to review student data and adjust support plans as needed. The school also launched a Check-In/Check-Out (CICO) intervention, which provides students with daily mentoring, goal setting, and feedback aligned with school expectations.

These efforts have strengthened student-adult relationships and supported the development of responsibility, self-regulation, and confidence among our students.

Clubs, Activities, and Enrichment

Morris Elementary School offers a wide variety of extracurricular opportunities that support student creativity, leadership, and collaboration. Students participate in intramural sports, Art Club, Chess Club, Chorus, and Band. The Crazy 8's Math Club promotes enthusiasm for problem solving, while the 5th Grade Service Club encourages leadership and civic responsibility. Students also take part in the Morris Spelling Bee and other academic enrichment activities.

Community partnerships further enhance student learning. Third grade students participate in environmental education through a partnership with the Massachusetts Audubon Society, culminating in a field experience at Pleasant Valley Wildlife Sanctuary.

Fifth grade students participate in an eight-week residency with Shakespeare & Company, working alongside professional actors and concluding with a live performance at the Tina Packer Playhouse. These experiences foster creativity, confidence, and teamwork.

Community Partnerships

Morris Elementary School continues to benefit from strong community

partnerships that enrich the educational experiences of our students. We are grateful for the support and collaboration of organizations including Shakespeare & Company, the Massachusetts Audubon Society, the Lenox Police and Fire Departments, Berkshire Community College, the Lenox Library, local businesses and banks, community service organizations, local courts, and LMMHS student mentors.

These partnerships provide valuable real-world learning opportunities and strengthen the connection between Morris Elementary School and the greater Lenox community.

Parent and Community Involvement

Morris Elementary School is fortunate to have an engaged and supportive parent and guardian community. Families contribute through the Parent-Teacher Organization (PTO) by organizing events, supporting enrichment programs, and assisting with school initiatives.

Parents and guardians also serve on the Morris School Council, which meets regularly with the principal to identify school priorities and support ongoing improvement efforts.

In 2016, the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education recognized Morris Elementary School as a National Blue Ribbon School of Excellence. Morris continues to demonstrate strong academic performance on the Massachusetts Comprehensive Assessment System (MCAS).

To promote diversity, equity, and inclusion, teachers intentionally select books and instructional materials that reflect a wide range of cultures and perspectives. Each grade level incorporates social justice lessons designed to foster empathy, cultural awareness, and respect for others.

The staff at Morris Elementary School remains dedicated to preparing students for a successful transition to middle and high school with strong academic skills and well-developed social-emotional competencies. Together, we strive to cultivate resilience, responsibility, and positive decision-making so that our students become engaged and productive members of the Lenox community and beyond.

Department of Student Services

Brian Kelley, Director of Student Services

The Department of Student Services oversees a comprehensive continuum of educational programming and supports designed to meet the diverse needs of students and families. The Department's responsibilities include Special Education, Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, English Language Education (ELE), Early Childhood Education/Integrated

Preschool, and services under the McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act.

The Department is committed to working collaboratively with students, families, educators, and community partners to maximize student achievement while honoring individual learning styles, strengths, and unique abilities.

Special Education

Lenox Public Schools provides a broad array of services for children and youth with disabilities from ages three through twenty-two. The referral, evaluation, and placement of students are governed by state and federal special education laws and regulations, including the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA).

The district remains committed to ensuring that each eligible student receives a Free Appropriate Public Education (FAPE) in the Least Restrictive Environment (LRE). Currently, approximately 12 % of the district's student population receives special education services. This percentage has increased slightly over the past several years, reflecting both expanded identification efforts and evolving student needs.

English Language Education (ELE)

Lenox Public Schools is dedicated to providing high-quality educational experiences for students whose primary language is not English. The English Language Education staff deliver instruction designed to foster grade-level social and academic language proficiency while supporting mastery of Massachusetts curriculum standards.

The ELE program currently serves approximately 30 students in grades K–12. The Department remains committed to ensuring full access to academic content and meaningful participation in all aspects of school life.

Section 504 Services

The Department is responsible for identifying, evaluating, and supporting students who have a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities, as defined under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973.

Students who qualify receive a 504 Accommodation Plan implemented within the general education setting. Each plan identifies the student's disability, the major life activities impacted, and the specific accommodations necessary to ensure equitable access to learning.

The district currently serves approximately 77 students under Section 504. Plans are reviewed annually to ensure continued effectiveness; however,

parents or staff may request a review at any time should adjustments be needed.

Integrated Preschool Program

The Integrated Preschool Program provides developmentally appropriate experiences in a safe, nurturing, and inclusive environment for three- and four-year-old children. The program follows an early childhood curriculum and operates using an integrated model in which students with disabilities learn alongside typically developing peers.

The program currently serves up to 24 students across two classrooms and continues to promote early learning, social-emotional development, and school readiness. During the 24-25 school year the program enrollment was 23 students. Several seats are held each year for Pediatric Development Center Referrals which typically come in during the middle of the school year.

McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act

The Director of Student Services also serves as the district liaison for students identified as homeless under the McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act. Homeless children and youth are defined as individuals who lack a fixed, regular, and adequate nighttime residence.

The district ensures that eligible students receive support and services that provide equal access to a free and appropriate public education comparable to that of their housed peers. In alignment with federal requirements, the district is currently coordinating and managing transportation for students identified as homeless to ensure school stability and to prevent disruption to their education. Providing consistent transportation enables students to remain in their school of origin whenever feasible, supporting academic continuity and social-emotional well-being.

Services may also include assistance with enrollment, access to educational programming, and coordination with community resources as needed.

Special Education Parent Advisory Council (SEPAC)

In accordance with Massachusetts General Law Chapter 71B and 603 CMR 28.07(4), Lenox Public Schools maintains an active Special Education Parent Advisory Council (SEPAC). The SEPAC meets monthly and plays an important advisory role within the district.

The responsibilities of the SEPAC include:

- Advising the district on matters related to the education and safety of students with disabilities
- Meeting regularly with school officials to participate in the planning, development, and evaluation of special education programs

- Establishing bylaws regarding officers and operational procedures

In collaboration with the district, SEPAC hosts at least one annual workshop focused on the rights of students and families under state and federal special education laws (MGL c.71B, §§1C and 3).

The mission of SEPAC is to promote understanding, respect, and support for all children in the community. Lenox Public Schools benefits from an active and engaged SEPAC membership, with approximately eight regular participants attending monthly meetings and advocating for the needs of students with disabilities. The Lenox SEPAC is very active and has regular monthly meetings and has added a webpage to educate families about the SEPAC.

We are grateful to the citizens of Lenox for sustaining this shared commitment and for supporting a system designed not only to educate children but also to strengthen the Commonwealth itself.

Respectfully submitted,
William E. Collins, Ed.D.
Superintendent of Schools

Personnel of the Public Schools 2025-2026

ADMINISTRATION

Dr. William E. Collins	Superintendent	Ed.D. Boston College, 2012 M.Ed. Bridgewater State College, 1997 B.A. Anna Maria College, 1988
Melissa J. Falkowski	Asst. Superintendent of Business and Operations	M.B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2017 B.S. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2011
Brian E. Kelley	Director of Student Services	M.S.W. Springfield College, 1998 B.A. Framingham State College, 1993
Randy McLeod	Director of Technology	B.S. University of Phoenix, 2014
Shannon Gagliardo	Director of Food Services	B.S. Johnson & Wales University, 2014
Brenda Kelley	Director of Curriculum, Instruction, & Assessment Principal, Morris	Ed.S. Simmons College, 2006 M.Ed. Cambridge College, 2001 B.A. North Adams State College, 1992
Holly Soules	Asst Principal, Morris	M.Ed. American International College, 2010 B.A. Western New England College, 2008
Dr. Jeremiah Ames	Principal, Lenox Memorial Middle and High School	Ed.D. Northeastern University, 2021 M.A. School for International Training, 2004 B.A. Cornell University, 1996
Marcus Hass	Asst Principal, Lenox Memorial Middle and High School	B.A. Castleton State College, 2012
Tom Hynes, III	LPS Facilities Coordinator Head Custodian, Morris	

FACULTY

Kimberly Abderhalden	Math Interventionist, LMMHS	M.Ed. Cambridge College, 2008 B.S. Westfield State University, 2004
Rene Altamar	Spanish, LMMHS	M.A. University of New Hampshire, 1991 B.A. University of Puerto Rico, 1985
Jessica Bazinet	ELA Interventionist, LMMHS	M.S. Simmons College, 2016 B.S. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2007 B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2005
Joseph Bazzano	Math, LMMHS	M.A. Endicott College, 2010 B.S. Northeastern University, 1987
Alexa Bermudez	Art, LMMHS	M.A. Savannah College of Art and Design, 2009 B.A. Westfield State College, 2007
Kyle Betters	Grade 5, Morris	M.A. Western New England University, 2020 B.S. Westfield State University, 2016
Lisa Budzek-Burr	Speech/Language Pathologist	M.S. Worcester State College, 1996 B.A. Rider College, 1984
Sarah Burdsall	Physical Education, LMMHS	M.S. Ithaca College, 1990 B.S. St. Lawrence University, 1984
Danielle Carlow	Special Education, LMMHS	M.Ed. American International College, 2013 B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2010
Melissa Clay	ELL, Morris	B.A. University of Massachusetts, 2001
Pamela Codey	Grade 4, Morris	M.Ed. American College of Education, 2019 M.Ed. Cambridge College, 2006 B.A. Westfield State College, 1992
Simona Collins	ELL, LMMHS	M.S. Alexandru Ioan Cuza University, 2007 B.A. Alexandru Ioan Cuza University, 2003

Susan Connolly	Special Education, Morris	M.S. So. Connecticut State University, 2000 B.S. So. Connecticut State University, 1980
Stephen Conuel	Special Education, LMMHS	M.A. University of Notre Dame, 2000 B.A. Western New England College, 1987
Matthew Côté	CAD/Technology, LMMHS	M.Ed. University of Massachusetts, 2000 B.S. Worcester Polytechnic Institute, 1993
Melanie Counsell	Grade 2, Morris	M.S. Simmons University, 2017 B.S. Westfield State, 2012
Brenda Crane	Grade 1, Morris	M.S. SUNY - Albany, 1992 B.S. SUNY - Geneseo, 1988
Jennifer Culver	Title I, Morris	M.Ed. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2003 B.S. Skidmore College, 1994
James Currie	Science, LMMHS	M.A. Boston University, 1992 B.S. Boston University, 1991
Kay Cuthbertson	Special Education, LMMHS	M.Ed. Lehigh University, 1998 B.A. University of Leeds, England, 1994
Lauren Davidson	Preschool, Morris	M.Ed. American International College, 2015 B.A. University Massachusetts Lowell, 2011
Nicole Derby	Grade 4, Morris	M.S. Simmons University, 2014 B.S. Framingham State University, 2011
Gabrielle DiSanto	Social Studies, LMMHS	M.Ed. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2022 B.A. Western New England University, 2017
Jennifer Drees	School Nurse	B.S. Grand Canyon University, 2014
Anne Dupuis	French, LMMHS	M.A. Middlebury Language School, 2005 B.A. Smith College, 1999
Margaret Esposito	Special Education, LMMHS	M.Ed. Westfield State University, 2022 B.A. St. Lawrence University, 2012
Ryan Evangelisto	Special Education, Morris	M.Ed. Simmons College, 2017 B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2015

Thomas Fielding	English, LMMHS	M.Ed. Cambridge College, 1998 B.A. University of Massachusetts, 1990
Colin Finnegan	Math, LMMHS	M.S. Western Governors University, 2025 B.A. Westfield State University, 2021
Rita Flynn	English, LMMHS	B.S. Boston University, 2015
Spencer Fraker	Special Education, LMMHS	M.Ed. American International College, 2019 B.S. University of Massachusetts, 2006
Eric Furlong	Woodshop, LMMHS	M.Ed. University of Massachusetts, 1998 B.S. University of Massachusetts, 1995
Shannon Gamberoni	Special Education, Morris	Ed.S. Simmons College, 2012 M.A. Cambridge College, 2003 B.A. Westfield State, 1999
Sarah Gerney	Grade 3, Morris	M.S. SUNY New Paltz, 2009 B.A. SUNY Geneseo, 1996
Robin Getzen	English, LMMHS	M.Ed. Harvard University, 2000 B.A. Vassar College, 1977
Evelyn Gonzalez*	Spanish, Morris	B.A. Purdue University, 1984
Matthew Gottfried	Math, LMMHS	M.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2017 B.S. University of Minnesota, 1990
Sara Hamilton	History, LMMHS	B.S. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2015 B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2015"
Amanda Hanlin-Hochler	ELA Specialist, Morris	M.Ed. Providence College, 2007 B.S. Ed. Westfield State College, 2004 B.A. Westfield State College, 2004
Sam Harb+	French/Spanish, LMMHS	M.A. SUNY-Albany, 1997 B.S. SUNY-Plattsburg, 1992
Tracy Hartshorn	Science, LMMHS	M.A. American International College, 2004 B.S. Roger Williams University, 1996
Amy Higgins	Adjustment Counselor, LMMHS	M.S. Stetson University, 2003 B.S. Cornell University, 1996
David Hilfinger	MS Guidance Counselor	M.Ed. Alfred University, 2008 B.A. SUNY, 2004

Rachel Horn	School Psychologist	M.S. College of St. Rose, 2019 B.A. Castleton State University, 2016
Brooke Kamienski	Science, LMMHS	M.Ed. American International College, 2010 B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2002
Brianna Kasala	Math, LMMHS	B.A. Providence College, 2022
Maureen Kennedy	Physical Education, Morris	M.A. Westfield State, College, 2003 B.S. Westfield State College, 2000
Shaun Kennedy	Kindergarten, Morris	M.Ed. American International College, 2012 B.S. Westfield State College, 2001
Asa Kerr	Social Studies, LMMHS	M.A. University of Michigan, 2023 B.A. Indiana University-Bloomington, 2013
Kelley Khoury-Cady	Social Studies, LMMHS	M.A. Cambridge College, 2006 B.A. Mass College of Liberal Arts, 1989
Matthew Knodler	Social Studies, LMMHS	M.Ed. Framingham State College, 2006 B.A. Westfield State College, 2002
Courtney Larkin	Preschool, Morris	M.Ed. Westfield State University, 2021 B.S. Westfield State University, 2017
Katie Lefkowitz	Speech/Language Pathologist	M.S. Worcester State University, 2007 B.S. Worcester State University, 2005
Pierre Léger	French, LMMHS	M.A. Université Sorbonne Nouvelle Paris 3, 2019 B.A. Université Sorbonne Nouvelle Paris 3, 2016 B.A. Institut Paul Bocuse, 1994
Sarah Leidhold	Grade 1, Morris	M.S. University of Albany, 2022 B.S. Worcester State University, 2015"
Susan Love	Grade 5, Morris	M.A. Lesley University, 1998 B.A. Providence College, 1994

Christopher Lovell	Latin, LMMHS	B.A. Reed College, 1996 M.A. University of Texas, 2000 Ph.D. University of Texas, 2011
Erin Maloy	Health and Wellness, LMMHS	M.S. Florida State University, 2010 B.S. Springfield College, 2002
Laura McCarthy	Health & Wellness, LMMHS	M.Ed. Springfield College, 2013 B.S. Springfield College, 2011
Heather McNeice	Business, LMMHS	C.A.G.S. Mass. College of Liberal Arts, 2012 M.S. Cambridge College, 2005 B.S. Siena College, 1996
Rachel Meczywor	Adjustment Counselor, LMMHS	M.S.W. Springfield College, 2018 B.S. Springfield College, 2017
Aimee Munday	Kindergarten, Morris	M. Ed. Cambridge College, 2009 B.A., St. Michael's College, 1998
Pamela Murray	Guidance Counselor, LMMHS	M.A. American International College B.A. Bay Path College, 1994
Karen Noyes	Grade 3, Morris	M.Ed. American International College, 2010 B.A. Bridgewater State College, 1991
Katrina Olender	Technology Instructor, Morris	M.A. Indiana University, 1998 M.A. Boston University, 1996 B.A. Simmons College, 1992
Lindsay Osterhoudt	Math Specialist, Morris	M.Ed. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2016 B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2005
Michelle Perkins	Grade 2, Morris	M.Ed. American International College, 2010 B.A. Berkshire Christian College, 1981
Bethany Persing	Adjustment Counselor, Morris	M.S.W. Springfield College, 2013 B.A. Westfield State University, 2006
Anna Pettus	Special Education, Morris	M.S. Simmons College, 2017 B.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2013

Sheena Piccolo	Spanish, LMMHS	M.Ed. American International College, 2013 B.A. Salve Regina University, 2007
Marjorie Pollard	Music, Morris	M.A. University of Hartford, 2011 B.A. University of Hartford, 1985 (Hartt School of Music)
Megan Porter	History, LMMHS	M.Ed. Westfield State University, 2018 B.A. Smith College, 2013
Kathryn Pratt	Librarian, LMMHS	M.A. Johnson State College, 2017 B.A. Elmira College, 2013
David Pugh	Math, LMMHS	M.A. Eastern Michigan University, 2001 B.S. University of Toledo, 1996
Thomas Renton+	Woodshop, LMMHS	B.S. Westfield State College, 2003
Ann-Marie Rodriguez	Spanish, LMMHS	Ph.D. American International College, 2016 M.A. Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, 1986 B.A. Salem State College, 1982
Tara Romeo	Guidance Counselor, LMMHS	M.A. Cambridge College, 2000 B.S. Boston College, 1992
Karen Romeo-Léger	Art, LMMHS	M.Ed. Mass. College of Liberal Arts, 2005 B.F.A. Syracuse University, 1996
Richard Sanders	Science, LMMHS	M.Ed. Westfield State University, 2006 B.S. Bloomsburg University, 1994
Ashley Scherben	Grade 4, Morris	M.Ed. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2011 B.A. Eastern Connecticut State University, 2007
Caroline Shebar	Science, LMMHS	B.S. Providence College, 2013 M.A. Bridgewater State University, 2021
Brian Shepardson	Special Education, LMMHS	M.A. Westfield State College, 1999 B.S. North Adams State College, 1994

Kathleen Shove	School Nurse, Morris	M.S. Grand Canyon University, 2024 B.S. The Sage Colleges, 2011
Katherine Simonelli	Grade 2, Morris	M.Ed. Simmons College, 2014 B.S. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2008
Amanda Soar	English, LMMHS	M.A. Boston College, 2006 B.S. Vanderbilt University, 2005
Mary Sorrentino	Math, LMMHS	M.A. University of Massachusetts, 1997 B.S. University of Vermont, 1990
Darcy Stall	Art, Morris	B.A. Westfield State, 2012 M.A. The Art of Education University, 2021
Peter Starenko	History, LMMHS	Ph.D. University of California, Berkeley, 2003 M.A. University of Oregon, 1990 B.A. Augustana College, 1987
Mathew Steckler	Music, LMMHS	Ph.D. New York University, 2013 M.A. New York University, 2007 M.A. New England Conservatory of Music, 1999 B.A. Wesleyan University, 1997
Brian Tolan	Science, LMMHS	M.S. University of California, Riverside, 1998 B.S. University of Massachusetts, Lowell, 1996
Eric Tyer	Physical Education, LMMHS	M.A. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2015 B.S. Springfield College, 2004
Krisit Vale-Cruz	Science, LMMHS	M.Ed. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2011 B.S. University of Rhode Island, 1999
Scott Wade	English, LMMHS	M.A. Stephen F. Austin State University, 2002 B.A. Stephen F. Austin State University, 2000
Benjamin Weaver	English, LMMHS	Ph.D. Duke University, 2000 M.A. Duke University, 1995 B.A. Columbia University, 1992
Lisa Wespiser	English, LMMHS	M.S. Simmons College, 2016 B.A. Pennsylvania State University, 2002

Jenna White	Grade 5, Morris	M.A. Fitchburg State, 2013 B.A. Assumption College, 2008
Aviva Wichler	Kindergarten, Morris	M.A. Hunter College, 1989 B.A. State University of New York, 1983
Emily Wood	Grade 2, Morris	M.Ed. College of Our Lady of the Elms, 2015 B.A. College of Our Lady of the Elms, 2011
Ceira Yantovsky	Grade 1, Morris	M.Ed. Massachusetts College of Liberal Arts, 2017 B.A. Westfield State University, 2013
Cherilyn Zaretsky	Adjustment Counselor, Morris	M.Ed. Fordham University, 2006 B.A. Boston College, 1999

SUPPORT / SERVICE STAFF

Shannon Adams	Special Education Paraprofessional, Morris
Suzanne Baczek*	Food Services, LMMHS
Ryan Bannen	Theater Manager, LMMHS
Nicole Brooks	Registrar, LMMHS
Ana Carpenter	Clerical Paraprofessional/Receptionist, Morris
Patrick Colvin	Building Substitute, LMMHS
Helen Coty-Curtin	Food Services Kitchen Supervisor, Morris
Cheryl Cummings*	Food Services, LMMHS
August Danowski	Assistant Principal's Administrative Assistant, LMMHS
Kristina Derouin	Food Services Supervisor, LMMHS
Sophie Digrigoli	Special Education Paraprofessional PreK, Morris
Judith Duval	Special Education Paraprofessional, LMMHS
Elizabeth Engelhard	Title I Interventionist, Morris
Heidi Ferren	Special Education Paraprofessional, Morris
Amy Freeman	Principal's Administrative Assistant, Morris
Adina Friedman	Special Education Paraprofessional, LMMHS
Nicole Gamberoni	Clerical Paraprofessional/Receptionist, LMMHS
Nancy Greenwald	Title I Interventionist, Morris
Susan Hanson	Accounting Assistant, Superintendent's Office
Noreen Hoag	Special Education Paraprofessional, Morris
Victoria Holt	Academic Interventionist, LMMHS
Maureen Jarvis	Special Education Paraprofessional, Morris
Susanna Keefe	Title I Interventionist, Morris

Kimberly Ketchen	Instructional Paraprofessional, Morris
Catherine Lefkowitz*	Instructional Paraprofessional, Morris
Michelle Loubert	DSS Administrative Assistant, Morris
Judy Miller	Instructional Paraprofessional, LMMHS
Laura Miniskis	P.E. Paraprofessional, Morris
Amy Noble Novitsky	Executive Assistant to the Superintendent
Tyra Nurmi	Instructional Paraprofessional, Morris
Jennifer O'Brien*	Food Services Cook, Morris
Molly O'Brien	Kindergarten Paraprofessional, Morris
Kelly Palubeckis	Special Education Paraprofessional, LMMHS
Nicole Patella	Guidance Administrative Assistant, LMMHS
Melissa Pehlert	Library Assistant, LMMHS
Lilian Pereira	Instructional Technology Support & PD Specialist
Kathy Pezze	Behavioral Intervention Specialist, Morris
Renee Robbins	Special Education Paraprofessional, LMMHS
Donna Rooney-Stalker	Special Education Paraprofessional, Morris
Gordon Roosa*	Food Services, Morris
Stephanie Sayers	Kindergarten Paraprofessional, Morris
Amanda Terzigni	Special Education Paraprofessional, LMMHS
Janet Tone	Library Paraprofessional, Morris
Catherine Touponce*	Food Services, LMMHS
Natalie Wicker	Building Substitute, Morris
Laura Zink	Building Clerk, Morris

CUSTODIAL STAFF

Jeffrey Ano	Custodian, LMMHS
Dale Armstrong	Custodian, LMMHS
Michael Bohin	Custodian, LMMHS
Dominic Boschetti	Custodian, LMMHS
Larry Decker	Custodian, Morris
Margaret MacDowell	Custodian, Morris
Nicholas Saldarini	Head Custodian, LMMHS
Liam Toole	Custodian, Morris
Peydon Twing*	Custodian, LMMHS

* Part-time

+Retired during the 2025-26 school year.

Report of the Scholarship Committee 2024-2025

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and Citizens of Lenox:

The Scholarship Committee is pleased to report that in June of 2025, \$24,100 was awarded through the Town of Lenox Scholarship Program to residents looking to further their education. Through the support of our donors, we were able to assist 12 graduates of the LMMHS class of 2025 and 19 post-graduate students. Awards ranged from \$100 to \$2,000.

The Lenox Scholarship Fund was established in 1989 to offer financial support to students who wish to pursue higher levels of education, graduate school, trade school, and other educational institutions. We have historically been able to increase the size of the program and the amount of the awards. However, our contributions were down significantly last year and as a result both the individual awards and the overall program were reduced. We continue to be increasingly dependent on a smaller group of contributors and the committee is considering ways to expand the program's fund raising. Each year, the fund is enhanced by a generous donation from the Kimball Farms Residents' Association. The fund also periodically receives donations from a variety of community organizations and in memory of community members.

This scholarship program is a credit to all the citizens of Lenox who continue to support our residents pursuing their education. The annual Lenox Town report lists many of the donors and benefactors.

The Scholarship Committee wishes to express its sincere gratitude to the 200+ contributors this year for their financial support of this program.

Respectfully submitted,

Dr. William E. Collins, Ex-Officio
Paula Downer
Amy Lafave
Bill Parsley
Tara Romeo
James Sorrentino

Scholarship Donors

23 Highcrest RD LLC	Delasco Paul & Meryl
Anonymous	Deluca Neil & Nina
Anonymous	Devereaux Family Trust
Anonymous	Diamond Carol & Herbert
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Barker Ed	Favero Al & Noreen
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Cattani Nardyne	Grinspoon Kenneth
Chapman Elisabeth	Hale Tryntje
Chin Theodore & Gloria	Hand Scott & Ellen
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Kaufman Charlotte Trust	Pringle J & Wallace K
Kelly Paul	Redniss Robin & Rick
Kimball Farms Residents' Association	Rimmeler David & Deborah
Kirby Ray & Diana	Roche Tom & Debbie
Kirsis Karlis & Margaret	Rose Helaine
Kopperl Joan & Paul	Rothenberg Fred & Stephanie
Krauss Tracy	Saba & Safta Trust
L & D Niedzielski	Sauer John
Lafave Amy	Schiffer Mike
Lane Edward & Robin	Scrimo Thomas & Nancy
Lazalde Family	Sermin Kat & McClelland Family
Leitermann Richard & Kathleen	Shapp Mark & Jennifer
Leitman Jeff & Louise	Sorrentino Frances & Michael
Lerner Linda	Stein Kerry
Lester Jennifer & Merklin Gregory	Stein Neil & Blank Judith
Levin Peter & Beth	Stern Daniel & Danielle
Linscott Holley Ann	Stollerman, Judith & Sandow Danielle
Lipkin Seth & Robak Rebeca	Sultan Stephan & Judith
Mahler Barb & Kenneth	Sweeney Deborah
Mahoney	Szecsei George & Judith
Mamolito Phil & Amy	Thompson Nancy & Charlie
McClenachan Felicity (Young)	Townson Seaman Lisa
McLean Paula	Van Agtmael Emily & Borden Ross
McNulty Vaughan Bob & Kate	Van Orman Glenn & Kathleen
Mikula Susan	Vincent Jeff & Sally
Milbauer Nancy & Alan	Wagstaff Paul & Carla
Mizia John & Renee	Weiss Olga
Montgomery Frances	Wells Robert Trust
Moore Lorence & Donna	Wheeler Robert
Moynihah Carol	White Marlene
Nash Paul & Kathryn	White Robert & Fondu Shirley
Nejaime Joseph & Dana	Winsor Dorothy
Novitsky David & Amy	Zaretsky Michael & Elen
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Parsley Family Fund	Zwick Jack & Anita
Pignatelli Scott & McNinch Kathleen	
Piretti Real Estate	
Porter Joseph & Laurie	

Report of the School Committee

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

The Lenox Public Schools exist to support the academic development and nurture the social and emotional growth of each child in a respectful environment that encourages lifelong learning and responsible citizenship.

- We celebrate excellence, growth, and doing hard things.
- We believe all our students belong as valued members of the Lenox community.
- We commit to hold our students to high expectations and inspire them academically, creatively, socially, and physically.
- We hold ourselves and each other accountable for respecting all individuals, their ideas, our rules, and shared spaces in our community.

EDUCATIONAL PROGRAM

The School Committee wishes to recognize the efforts of the administrators, teachers, and support staff who work tirelessly to deliver an outstanding educational experience for our community's children.

Our administration is led by our Superintendent, William Collins, Assistant Superintendent Melissa Falkowski, Director of Student Services Brian Kelley, and Director of Curriculum, Instruction, and Assessment Brenda Kelley. Ms. Kelley also serves as Principal at Morris Elementary School, with Assistant Principal Holly Soules. At Lenox Memorial Middle and High School (LMMHS), Jeremiah Ames serves as Principal and Marcus Hass as Assistant Principal. We are grateful for the thought, care, and passion that these outstanding leaders bring to our schools every day.

Lenox's small size and deep commitment to public education has given our schools a distinct advantage in providing all students with the personal attention they need while also delivering the robust and innovative program characteristic of a much larger district. Standardized test scores at both schools are among the highest in the commonwealth and the district is the

employer of choice for the area's most dedicated and talented educators. Great teachers are what make great schools and we are very fortunate to have some of the best.

Last year, Morris Elementary, which serves approximately 320 students in grades pre-K through 5, was the sole recipient of the Massachusetts Reading Association's Exemplary Reading Program Award. At LMMHS, which serves approximately 440 students in grades 6 through 12, course offerings include three foreign languages and electives ranging from computer programming to documentary film writing and jazz ensemble to business marketing. Dozens of extracurricular activities run each year, from competitive quiz bowl and robotics teams to robust music and drama programs to more than twenty athletics programs.

ENROLLMENT

The October 1, 2025 enrollment in Lenox Public Schools was 763. Enrollment levels remain steady.

FACILITIES

It has been nearly 30 years since Lenox undertook a major school construction project. Careful attention to maintenance has kept both school buildings in excellent condition and fit for purpose, however they have reached the point where substantial investments are needed. The Committee has worked closely with Town officials to develop a comprehensive five-year plan for renovations that will extend the lives of the buildings far into the future and avoid the much larger cost of new construction. These include: new roofs, parking lot improvements, and second-floor cooling for both buildings; new locker rooms and a small addition for new science classrooms at LMMHS; and a new HVAC system for the Duffin Theater. State funding will cover a portion of the roof-related costs. We will present the full five-year plan at Town Meeting.

PROPOSED BUDGET

The operating budget that we are presenting at Town Meeting for the 2026-27 (FY '27) school year has gone through a four-month process of development. The Superintendent and his team have determined the expenditures necessary to maintain the district's outstanding program, aiming only to maintain level service while postponing any new investments per guidance from the Town Manager. The School Committee oversees the process by

setting goals for the district, the Finance Subcommittee collaborates closely with the administrative team on building the budget, and then each element is presented and discussed in public meetings. Each program has been reviewed in detail and with consideration of projected Town Revenues and other resources available to fund our schools.

THE SCHOOL COMMITTEE

In the Town elections on May 5, 2025, Kim Winger was elected for a new three-year term; Oren Cass and Jayson Messenger were elected for two-year terms. The School Committee elected the following officers: Chair, Oren Cass; Vice-Chair, Michael Dupont; and Secretary, Kim Graham. After Veronica Fenton’s resignation, Richard Burke was appointed for a one-year term.

Much of the committee’s work is done through its subcommittees:

Finance

Development and refinement of annual operating and capital budgets, review of ongoing expenditures, supporting the administration on other financial issues that may arise

Mike DuPont (chair)
Kim Graham
Kim Winger

Human Resources

Relationship with LEA and contract negotiations, organization structure and job descriptions, supporting the administration on other personnel issues that may arise

Meghan Kirby (chair)
Richard Burke
Oren Cass

Governance & Policy

Ongoing development of proposed policy revisions as necessary for consideration by full committee

Meghan Kirby (chair)
Kim Graham
Jayson Messenger

Technology

Examination of existing uses of technology in schools; opportunities and concerns; potential resources or policy changes

Oren Cass (chair)
Jayson Messenger
Kim Winger

RECOGNITION

We are greatly indebted to the PTO members at each school, our two School Councils, the Special Education Parents’ Advisory Council, and the ever-active athletic booster organizations.

We would also like to recognize and congratulate many longtime Lenox Public Schools staff who have recently retired from the district: Mary Cherry, Linda Consolini, Ellen Farris, Sam Harb, Lynne Nilan and Tom Renton. We will miss their skills, passion, and care for our students and their

contributions to our school community. We would also like to recognize our assistant superintendent, Melissa Falkowski, who will retire at the start of the next school year. Her careful attention to the budget and operations of our schools has been indispensable to supporting the education of our students and she leaves us in a strong position for the coming years.

Finally, we wish to express our gratitude to the Town and its citizens for your consistent and generous support. The Lenox Public Schools never take this support for granted—to the contrary, we talk about it often—and we always strive to steward our resources responsibly. We are all very fortunate to live in a community that places such high priority on the quality of our schools and dedicates so much to giving children the best possible education, and we all enjoy the benefits of that commitment as well.

Members for the 2025 calendar year:

Oren Cass, Chair
Michael DuPont, Vice-Chair
Kim Graham, Secretary
Richard Burke
Veronica Fenton
Meghan Kirby
Jayson Messenger
Robert Munch
David Rimmler
Kim Winger
Greta Mathews, Student Representative

Respectfully submitted by:
Oren Cass
Chair, Lenox School Committee

Report of the Land Use Department

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and the Citizens of Lenox:

2025 was a busy year for the Land Use Department. EOHLIC granted additional Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) funding to continue Lenox's housing rehabilitation program. Bailey Boyd Associates, Inc. was selected through an RFP process to administer this program for the Town. Moreover, the Dept., Library, and Community Center worked collaboratively to identify technology needs and were awarded \$56k in grant funding through MBI's Digital Equity Implementation Program. Additionally, the Rural Development Fund awarded \$50k to study potential zoning amendments related to future sewer extensions in the community. The Land Use Department continued work with the Planning Board in its effort to address complex zoning bylaw amendments, including permitting Mobile Food Establishments (food trucks), as well as changes to the Town's ADU's bylaw to ensure compliance with state regulations.

Looking ahead to 2026, the Department will continue to explore opportunities to address workforce housing through the Commonwealth's new Seasonal Communities designation, as well as begin to update the Town's Open Space and Recreation and ADA Self-Evaluation and Transition Plan. Significant public input will be needed for both planning efforts. Both plans will help Lenox to unlock future grant opportunities. The Land Use Department strives to be a resource for anyone in Lenox who chooses to invest their business in the community. It is also a resource for prospective, new, and long-time homeowners seeking to improve their properties.

It has been my honor and privilege to serve in Lenox since joining Town Hall in January of 2025. The Town's committed citizenry and the expertise and devotion of its volunteer boards are a major strength that sets Lenox apart from other communities. I joined Lenox with a decade of previous planning experience with the Town of Adams and the Berkshire Regional Planning Commission.

Please contact the Land Use Dept. with any questions. Your perspective, experience and ideas are welcome and important, even when it may seem like there may not be immediate resolution, agreement, or consensus—your attention, presence and input is valued.

Take a look at the town calendar to see if any Land Use meetings interest you--we welcome new volunteers of all backgrounds and there are available positions on specific boards and committees.

Sincerely,
Eammon Coughlin

Report of the John Drummond Kennedy Park Restoration Committee

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

We are happy to announce that the ten acres owned by the Smith family have been added to Kennedy Park. The acreage has been of interest for many years. The Aspinwall trail runs through the middle of it and the parcel is adjacent to the Cold Spring and Woolsey trails. Many thanks to Town Manager Jay Green, Town Planner Eammon Coughlin, the Community Preservation Committee for meeting with us off cycle, Bob Coakley and Joe Nolan for pursuing this for many years, to the Smith family for their patience while we lined up the necessary funding and most of all to the voters of Lenox for your unanimous approval to spend \$250,00 to purchase this parcel with Community Preservation Act open space funds.

The meeting minutes of this committee were preserved by the Northeast Document Conservation Center (NEDCC). Many thanks to Kerry Sullivan for expediting this project.

The mission of the KP committee is trail maintenance. Many volunteers spent countless hours removing downed trees, cleaning ditches and water bars as well as adding signage and providing help to upkeep the map boxes. An old section of the asphalt driveway that circled the Aspinwall Hotel was cleared and signs added to honor George “Gige” Darey who always said he needed to “get a head of steam up” to make it up the hill from the water tank. The DPW placed a bench at the intersection of the Main and the new trail; “Ripton”.

Thanks to Bill Gop and Ray Kirby from the DPW for their invaluable help all year. Sadly, we lost two remarkable volunteers this year with the death of Art Stringer and Luke Martin. We are looking forward to some new projects in 2026.

Respectfully submitted,
Ruth Wheeler, Chair

Report of the Planning Board

Tom Delasco

Pam Kueber

Kathleen McNulty-Vaughan

Dan Bross

Mark Smith

To the Honorable Board of Selectmen and the Citizens of Lenox:

Thank you for this opportunity to provide an update on the activities of the Planning Board over the past year.

The Planning Board's principal ongoing role is to develop land-use regulations and plans that address Town needs, taking care to balance individual liberties and the welfare of the community as a whole. The Board researches, writes and amends our Zoning Bylaws. It may review Special Permit projects and provide input on bylaw requirements to the Zoning Board of Appeals related to site plan characteristics and accordance with the Master Plan and other community plans. The Planning Board is the Special Permit Granting Authority for Open Space Flexible Developments and is the review entity for subdivisions in the Town of Lenox. And, it takes the lead in developing and monitoring progress of the Town's Master Plan, which guides the long-term physical development of the Town and supports decision-making at board, committee and staff levels.

In 2025, this volunteer Board convened 23 times. It held two public hearings and brought zoning bylaw recommendations to Annual Town Meeting and the fall Special Town Meeting; a new Mobile Food Establishments bylaw to allow for and regulate food trucks, a clarified Fencing bylaw and a revised Accessory Dwelling Unit bylaw to conform with new state regulations, all of which the Town voted to accept. Members devoted substantial personal time and energy to each meeting and each topic brought to its attention.

The Planning Board is currently working on amendments to the following Zoning Bylaws, which are outdated or otherwise need attention:

- A totally rewritten Sign bylaw which allows for more flexibility and better enforcement.
- An updated Institutional Uses bylaw which will be in compliance with State law.
- A new Battery Energy Systems bylaw to address potential sitings that are allowed by state law.

All meetings of the Planning Board are open to the public. The Board meets the second and fourth Tuesday of each month.

Sincerely,
Tom Delasco, Chair

Report of the Building Department

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

I hereby submit my report for the calendar year 2024, the following is the list of permits by category, the number of permits issued by category and the resultant permit fees collected by this department:

Category	Issued	Permit Fees
Residential	307	\$134,602.50
Commercial	124	\$344,937.00
Sheet Metal	22	\$1,850.00
Trench	39	\$2,145.00
Solid Fuel	2	\$140.00
Tent	33	\$2,800.00
Sign	11	\$1,510.00
Certificate of Inspection (CofI)	161	\$24,625.00
Certificate of Occupancy (Residential/Commercial)	3	\$220.00
Electric	270	\$68,696.00
Gas	89	\$4,320.00
Plumbing	124	\$34,955.00
Total	1185	\$620,800.50

The Building Department is committed to assisting the public through the permitting and inspection process. Please contact our department for any building and zoning inquiries.

Matt Kollmer, Building Commissioner
Adam Vanderneck, Local Inspector
Rian Dowd, Local Inspector
Don Fitzgerald, Local Inspector
Carolyn Hogencamp, Administrative Assistant

Respectfully Submitted,
Matt Kollmer
Building Commissioner

Report of the Department of Veterans' Services

To the Honorable Select Board and Citizens of Lenox:

The Veterans' Services office serves the Veterans of Lenox and their families. We assist veterans in processing requests for Massachusetts Department of Veterans' Services (DVS) Chapter 115 benefits. Chapter 115 benefits are needs based, and include temporary financial assistance, medical reimbursement, and assistance in applying for aid from other agencies, both state and federal. Veterans with a dishonorable discharge are not eligible. Spouses and dependent children may also be eligible, if the veteran is eligible.

The case load of Lenox Veterans' Services constant this year. The cost to assist veterans this year with Chapter 115 benefits was \$6,348.95. Of this amount, 75% (\$4,761.71) will be reimbursed by the state, with an actual cost to the Town of \$1,587.24. This includes regular benefits, heating assistance, and medical reimbursements.

As noted last year, the Veterans' Service Officer (VSO) of Lenox can no longer can assist veterans and their spouses with federal Veterans' Administration (VA) requests. A new VA rule prevents me from filling out VA paperwork. However, we have a list of local organizations that can assist the veteran so that they will receive the benefits they deserve.

As noted in previous reports, one of the most underused programs available to veterans is a program that allows a Veteran to receive Medical Only benefits, in the event their income is too high for regular benefits. Maximum asset limits still apply. Maximum assets are \$8,400.00 single, and \$16,600.00 married. If approved, the Medical Only program reimburses co-pays, other medical costs, and can even reimburse the cost of Medicare Part B and some supplemental insurances. It must be noted that, Veteran Services does not pay the bills, but reimburses medical bills paid for by the veteran.

If someone is wondering if they are eligible for benefits, there is a link on the Town website under Veterans Services that can be used to see if a veteran, or their spouse, is eligible for benefits.

The Veterans' Service Officer is part time, working out of the same office as the Town Clerk.

Office hours are Tuesday's from 4:00 – 6:00.

Respectfully Submitted by,
Doug Mann
Lenox Veterans' Service Officer (Veterans' Agent)

Annual Town Meeting
May 1, 2025

At 7:16 p.m. the Annual Town Meeting held at the Lenox Memorial Middle High School was called to order by Moderator John J. McNinch. A quorum for the meeting was met with over 165 present at the opening.

ARTICLE 1. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to waive the reading of the warrant and return of service thereof and to authorize the moderator, pursuant to MGL Chapter 39, Section 15, to declare a 2/3rds vote on voice votes if he deems it so.

ARTICLE 2. It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to appropriate \$11,244,426 and to provide for said appropriation, raise and appropriate \$10,744,426 and transfer \$500,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2024 for the operating expenses of the Town for Fiscal Year 2026 as printed in the warrant.

	JULY 1. 2024 to JUNE 30. 2025	JULY 1. 2025 to JUNE 30. 2026
1. Admin. & Finance	359,854	444,148
2. Town Clerk	93,262	104,924
3. Town Treasurer/Collector	157,407	203,245
4. Compensation Reserve	110,000	213,000
5. Operations Support	109,500	167,100
6. Elections & Registration	18,195	14,414
7. Economic Dev/Advertising	134,060	140,000
8. Town Debt & Interest	246,125	1,266,840
9. Audit, Reserve Account	913,104	930,443
10. Insurance Gt Bonds, OPEB	880,186	743,616
11. Land Use Department	533,134	184,104
Assessor		152,943
Building/Inspection Services		205,392
12. Town Buildings	231,067	238,988
General Government Subtotal	3,785,894	5,009,157
13. Police Department	1,614,632	1,708,750
14. Fire Department	780,371	912,499
15. Emergency Management	38,185	5,500
16. Ambulance Squad	614,518	634,828
Public Safety Subtotal	3,047,706	3,261,577
17. Vocational Education	202,107	212,212
Education Subtotal	202,107	212,212

18. Highway Department	781,566	897,091
19. Snow & Ice	257,005	257,005
20. Cemetery	33,924	37,987
Public Works Subtotal	1,072,495	1,192,083
21. Board of Health	276,287	299,595
22. Veterans Services	30,372	30,374
Human Services Subtotal	306,659	329,969
23. Lenox Library	505,686	614,038
24. Community Center	517,426	563,877
25. Cultural Council Grants	10,000	10,000
26. Cultural District	15,000	15,000
27. Academy Building	8,063	8,063
28. Historical Commission	25,950	25,950
29. Celebrations	2,255	2,500
Cultural & Recreation Subtotal	1,084,380	1,239,428
Totals	\$9,499,241	11,244,426

APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE

ARTICLE 3. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to appropriate \$17,839,358 and to provide for said appropriation, raise and appropriate \$17,689,358 and transfer the sum of \$150,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2024 for the operating expenses of the Lenox Public Schools for the Fiscal Year 2026.

	JULY 1. 2024 to JUNE 30. 2025	JULY 1. 2025 to JUNE 30. 2026
Lenox Public Schools	\$16,855,665	\$17,839,358

APPROVED BY SCHOOL COMMITTEE
APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE

ARTICLE 4. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to make the following appropriations to fund the Fiscal Year 2026 budget for the Sewer Department;

- 1. Sewer Operations \$1,105,492
- 2. Debt Service \$942,634
- 3. Capital Expenditures \$220,000

TOTAL \$2,268,126

And, further, to provide for said appropriations from the following sources of revenue and available funds:

User Charges	\$2,006,092
Retained Earnings	\$262,034
TOTAL	\$2,268,126

APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE

ARTICLE 5. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to make the following appropriations to fund the Fiscal Year 2026 budget for the Water Department;

1. Water Operations	\$842,935
2. Debt Service	\$230,752
3. Capital Expenditures	\$100,000
4. Transfer to Reserve	\$453,220
TOTAL	\$1,626,907

And further, to provide for said appropriations from the following sources of revenue and available funds:

User Charges	\$1,526,907
Retained Earnings	\$100,000
TOTAL	\$1,626,907

APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE

ARTICLE 6. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to accept funds being provided by the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in Fiscal Year 2026 under the provisions of Chapter 90 of the General Laws, to pay for such costs as allowed by appropriate legislation in connection with the maintenance, repair, and construction of Town ways and bridges.

ARTICLE 7. It was moved, seconded and approved by a voice-vote to appropriate the sum of \$1,090,460 for the following departmental capital expenditures:

1 Public Works Department Expenditures	\$276,000
2 Technology Expenditures	\$50,000
3 School Department Expenditures	\$400,000
4 Fire Department Expenditures	\$25,000
5 EMS Expenditures	\$123,000
6 Police Department Expenditures	\$25,000
7 Elections Expenditures	\$25,000
8 Academy Building Expenditures	\$10,000
9 Administration & Finance Expenditures	\$50,000
10 Board of Health Expenditures	\$6,460
11 Community Center Expenditures	\$100,000

*APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE*

And further, to provide for said appropriations, to transfer from Free Cash as certified on July 1, 2024, the sum of \$1,090,460.

ARTICLE 8. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved by a 2/3 vote to appropriate the sum of \$1,200,000 to pay the costs of design and construction for upgrading and extending the water main on Holmeswood Terrace, including payment of all costs incidental and related thereto; and that to meet this appropriation, the Treasurer, with the approval of the Selectmen, is authorized to borrow said amount pursuant to M.G.L. c. 44, s. 8(5), of the General Laws, or pursuant to any other enabling authority, and to issue bonds or notes of the Town thereto.

*APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE*

ARTICLE 9. It was moved seconded and unanimously approved to appropriate or reserve for future appropriation, from the Community Preservation Fund annual revenues in the amounts recommended by the Community Preservation Committee for committee administrative expenses, community preservation projects, and other expenses in fiscal year 2026, as appearing in the Warrant for this Annual Town Meeting, with each item to be considered a separate appropriation.

CPA FY26 Preservation Fund Reserves & Appropriations

From FY26 annual revenues for Historic Preservation reserve	\$48,164.77 + \$4,382*
From FY26 annual revenues for Community Housing reserve	\$48,164.77 + \$4,382*
From FY26 annual revenues for Open Space and Recreation reserve	\$48,164.77 + \$4,382*
From FY26 annual revenues to Administrative Expenses (Admin Expenses are 5% of Annual Revenues)	\$24,082.39

* Includes additional DOR recommended funding of \$4,382. Town did not appropriate full 10% of annual revenues toward each reserve fund last year.

SPONSORED BY COMMUNITY PRESERVATION COMMITTEE

ARTICLE 10. It was moved seconded and approved by voice-vote to appropriate from the Community Preservation Fund for FY26 the following amounts, as appearing in the warrant, recommended by the Community Preservation Committee, with each item to be considered a separate appropriation.

CPA FY26 Community Preservation Projects

Project	Total Appropriation	Funding Source
		FY26 Annual Revenues Reserve Fund Balance
HISTORIC PRESERVATION		
1. Church on the Hill – ADA Improvements, Lighting, Foundation Repair		
	\$117,152 \$64,605.23	\$52,546.77
2. The Mount - Entrance Gate Restoration		
	\$109,408 \$109,408	\$0
Subtotal, Historic Preservation		\$226,560
TOTAL	\$226,560	

SPONSORED BY COMMUNITY PRESERVATION COMMITTEE

ARTICLE 11. It was moved and seconded to appropriate the sum of \$1,900,000 for the purchase of a new ladder truck, equipment and other related costs; and, further, to provide for said appropriation, transfer the balance of \$1,100,000 from the Fire Engine Stabilization Account and \$800,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2024.

Sonya Bykofsky, 225 Main St. moved to amend the motion to drop and \$800,000 from Free Cash, so called. The amendment was moved, seconded and defeated on voice-vote.

It was then moved, seconded and unanimously approved to appropriate the sum of \$1,900,000 for the purchase of a new ladder truck, equipment and other related costs; and, further, to provide for said appropriation, transfer the balance of \$1,100,000 from the Fire Engine Stabilization Account and \$800,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2024.

*APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE*

ARTICLE 12. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to appropriate the sum of \$130,000 to be placed in the Ambulance Stabilization Account; and, further, to provide for said appropriation, transfer the sum of \$130,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2024.

*APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE*

ARTICLE 13. It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to appropriate the sum of \$250,000 to be placed in the Debt Stabilization Account; and, further, to provide for said appropriation, transfer the sum of \$250,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2024.

*APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE*

ARTICLE 14. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to accept General Laws Chapter 59, Section 5, Clause 22I, which authorizes an annual increase in the amount of the exemption by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) for the previous year as determined by

the Commissioner of Revenue, to be effective for applicable exemptions granted for any fiscal year beginning on or after July 1, 2025.

*APPROVED BY BOARD OF ASSESSORS
APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE*

ARTICLE 15. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to accept General Laws Chapter 59, Section 5, Clause 22J, which authorizes an annual increase in the amount of the exemption by 100% of the personal exemption amount, subject to the conditions in Clause 22J, to be effective for applicable exemptions granted for any fiscal year beginning on or after July 1, 2025.

*APPROVED BY BOARD OF ASSESSORS
APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE*

ARTICLE 16. It was moved and seconded to amend the Zoning Bylaw by creating a new Section 8.19, “Mobile Food Establishments,” as well as associated changes to Section 4, “Definitions,” and Section 5.2, “Schedule of Uses” as set out in the handout at Town Meeting.

Thomas Delasco, 12 Hillside Drive, Chair of the Planning Board moved to amend the motion “Section 5.2 – Schedule of Uses” from N to Y for all residential zones for Mobile Food Establishments”.

The motion was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to accept the amendment.

It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to amend the Zoning Bylaw by creating a new Section 8.19, “Mobile Food Establishments,” as well as associated changes to Section 4, “Definitions,” and Section 5.2, as amended and voted by the Town by voice-vote “Schedule of Uses” as set out in the handout at Town Meeting.

*APPROVED BY PLANNING BOARD
APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD*

ARTICLE 17. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to amend the Special Education Stabilization Fund current cap of \$250,000 to the maximum amount allowable, which is 2% of the Annual Net School Spending Total as allowed by Chapter 40, Section 13E of the General Laws.

APPROVED BY SCHOOL COMMITTEE
APPROVED BY SELECT BOARD
APPROVED BY FINANCE COMMITTEE

ARTICLE 18. It was moved, seconded and unanimously approved to appropriate the sum of \$246,078 for the Wastewater Collection System Asset Management Plan which is comprised of a \$147,647 reimbursable grant, in-kind services (non-cash) provided by the Town valued at \$68,902 and a cash contribution from the Town valued at \$29,529 to be paid from the sewer enterprise funds; and to authorize the Director of Public Works to act on behalf of the Town to file for and accept funds in connection with the Grant and the Project, including entering into a financial assistance agreement with Clean Water Trust, on such terms and conditions as the Director of Public Works and the Clean Water Trust shall agree and to submit any and all documents and certifications necessary or advisable.

It was voted unanimously to adjourn the meeting at 8:43 a.m. and to reconvene on Monday, May 5, 2025 at the Lenox Town Hall for the purpose of voting for Town Officers.

A true copy.
 Kerry L. Sullivan, CMMC
 Lenox Town Clerk



Special Town Meeting

November 6, 2025

At 7:05 PM a Special Town Meeting held at the Lenox Memorial Middle & High School was called to order by Moderator John McNinch. A quorum for the meeting was met with over 33 voters present at the opening.

ARTICLE 1. It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to waive the reading of the warrant and return of service thereof and to authorize the moderator, pursuant to MGL Chapter 39, Section 15, to declare a 2/3rds vote on voice votes if he deems it so.

ARTICLE 2. It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote of a 2/3 majority to authorize the Select Board:

- (a) to acquire, by purchase, a fee simple interest in property located off Woolsey Road, Lenox, containing 10 acres, more or less, identified by the Assessors as Parcel 22-3-0, and being the premises described in a deed recorded with the Berkshire Middle Registry of Deeds in Book 525, Page 337, for open space, conservation and passive recreational purposes, to be a portion of Kennedy Park AND
- (b) that the Town vote to transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, the amount of \$250,000 for the purpose of funding said acquisition and costs incidental or related thereto; AND
- (c) to authorize the Select Board to grant a restriction on said parcel in compliance with G.L. Chapter 44B, Section 12(a); and, further
- (d) to authorize the Select Board to enter into all agreements and execute any and all instruments on behalf of the Town as may be necessary or appropriate to effectuate said acquisition or take any other action in relation thereto.

ARTICLE 3. It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to appropriate from the Community Preservation Fund for FY26 the following amounts recommended by the Community Preservation committee; or to take any other action relative thereto. From the open space reserve fund - \$250,000 for the purchase of 10 acres of land adjacent to Kennedy Park to be permanently protected as open space.

ARTICLE 4. It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to indefinitely postpone Article 4:

- (a) to acquire, by purchase, gift or eminent domain, a fee simple interest in property located at 41 Housatonic Street and 51 Housatonic Street,

Lenox, identified by the Assessors as Parcel 43_121_0 and Parcel 43_122_0, respectively, and being a portion of the premises described in a deed recorded with the Berkshire Middle Registry of Deeds in Book 5109, Page 309, for general municipal purposes, including, but not limited to, parking and redevelopment AND

- (b) that the town vote to transfer the sum of \$1,000,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2025 for the purpose of funding said acquisition and costs incidental or related thereto AND
- (c) to authorize the Select Board to enter into all agreements and execute any and all instruments on behalf of the Town as may be necessary or appropriate to effectuate said acquisition or take any other action in relation thereto.

ARTICLE 5.: It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to transfer the sum of \$65,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2025 for capital expenditures at the Lenox Library; or take any other action in relation thereto.

ARTICLE 6.: It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to transfer the sum of \$304,000 from Free Cash, so called, as Certified on July 1, 2025 for the purpose of funding a short term interest payment on the Bond Anticipation Note (BAN) for the Wastewater Treatment Plant Upgrade Project; and, further to transfer said appropriation to the Wastewater Enterprise Fund; or take any other action in relation thereto.

ARTICLE 7.: It was moved, seconded and approved by a voice-vote to transfer the sum of \$29,000.00 from Free Cash, so called, as certified on July 1, 2025, for capital expenditures in the Fire and Rescue Department; or take any other action in relation thereto.

ARTICLE 8.: It was moved, seconded and approved by a voice-vote to appropriate the sum of \$49,102.83 to the Lenox Affordable Housing Trust and, further, to provide for said appropriation, transfer said sum from available funds; or take any other action in relation thereto.

ARTICLE 9.: It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote to amend the General Bylaws so as to replace existing Chapter XXVIII with "Operation of Short-Term Rentals" with a new Chapter XXVIII "Operation of Short-Term Rentals" as set out in a handout at Special Town Meeting and in substantially the same form as discussed at the Select Board

Public Hearing held on October 8, 2025; or take any action in relation hereto.

ARTICLE 10.: It was moved, seconded and approved by voice-vote of a 2/3 majority to amend the Zoning Bylaw by revising Section 6.1.12 “Fencing” as well as associated changes to Section 6.1.13 “Screening” as set out in a handout at Special Town Meeting and in substantially the same form as discussed at the Planning Board Public Hearing held on October 14th, 2025; or take any action in relation hereto.

ARTICLE 11.: It was moved. seconded and unanimously approved with a 2/3 majority to amend the Zoning Bylaw by amending Section 9.2 “Accessory Dwelling Unit” as set out in a handout at Special Town Meeting and in substantially the same form as discussed at the Planning Board Public Hearing held on October 14th, 2025; or take any action in relation hereto.

It was voted unanimously to dissolve the meeting at 7:37 PM.

Attest: Kerry L. Sullivan, CMMC

